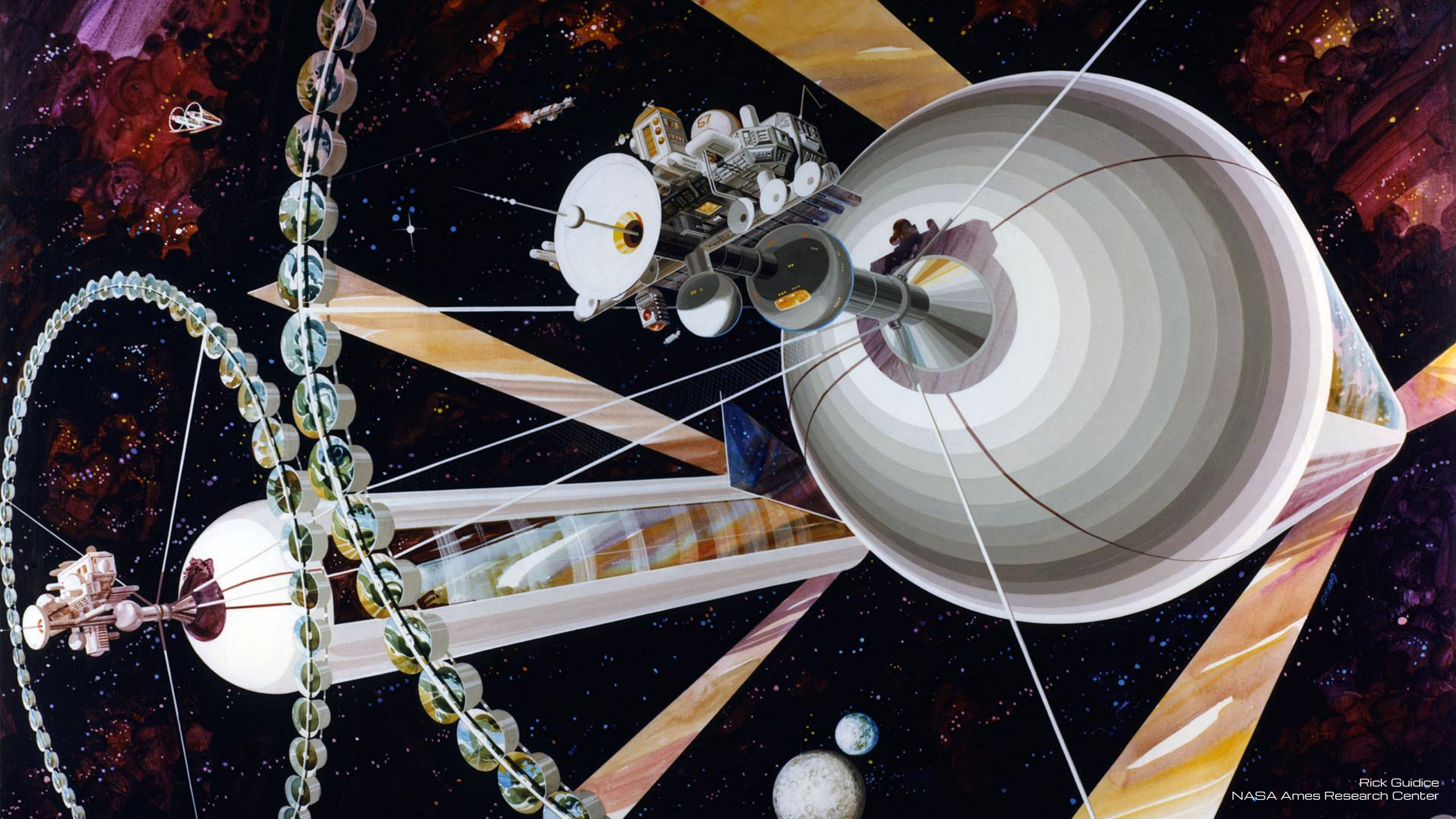






THE WAY THE FUTURE WAS

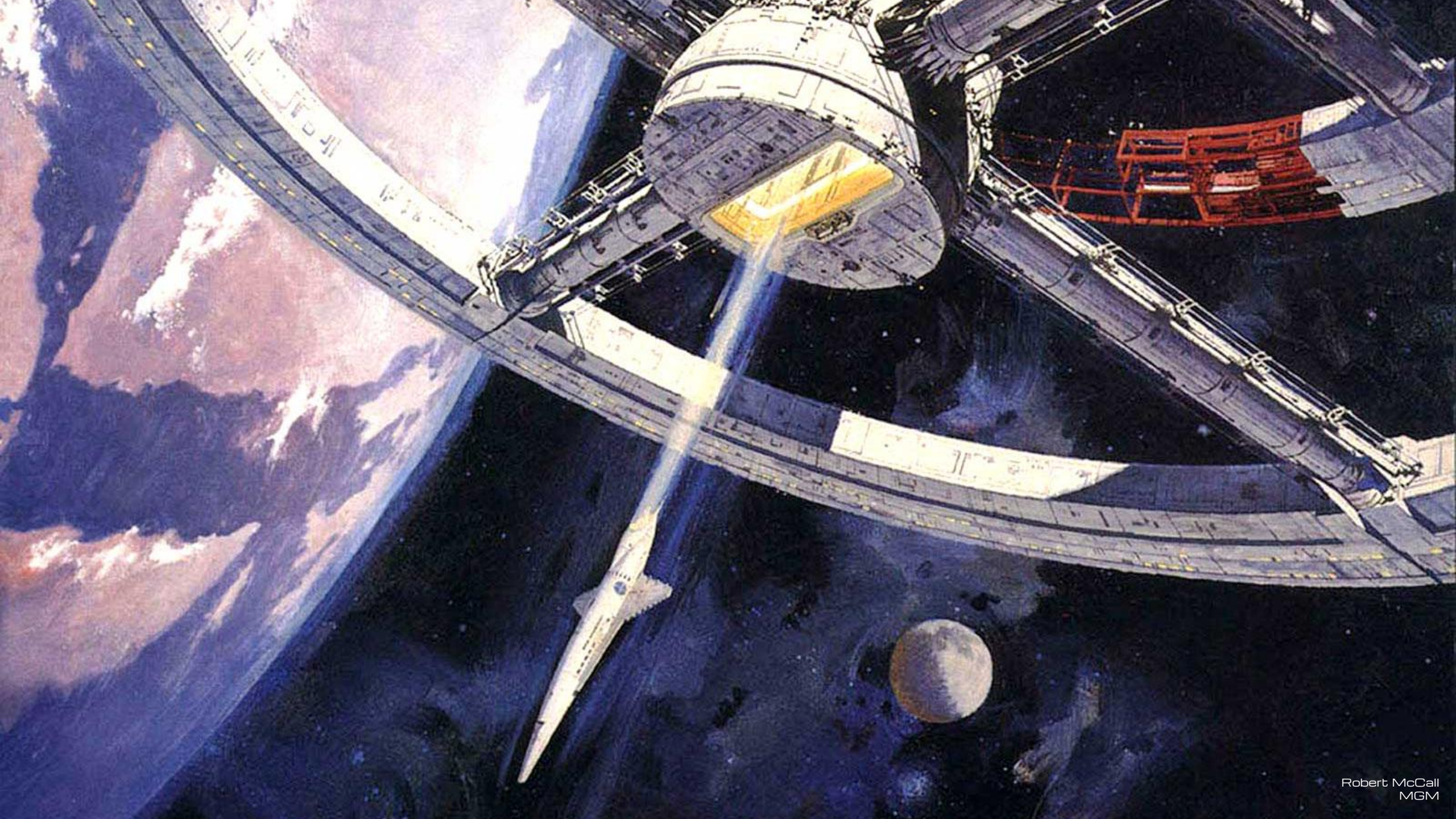
James & Kevlin



- To Place a call
Press the ON button.
- To Receive a call
When the light is on, pick up the handset.
- During the Call
To center your picture, hold the V button.
- To adjust the volume, use the control knob.
- The OFF button turns the phone off.
- To restore the phone to standby, press the T button.
- A call may be made using the handset or the ON or OFF button.
- To

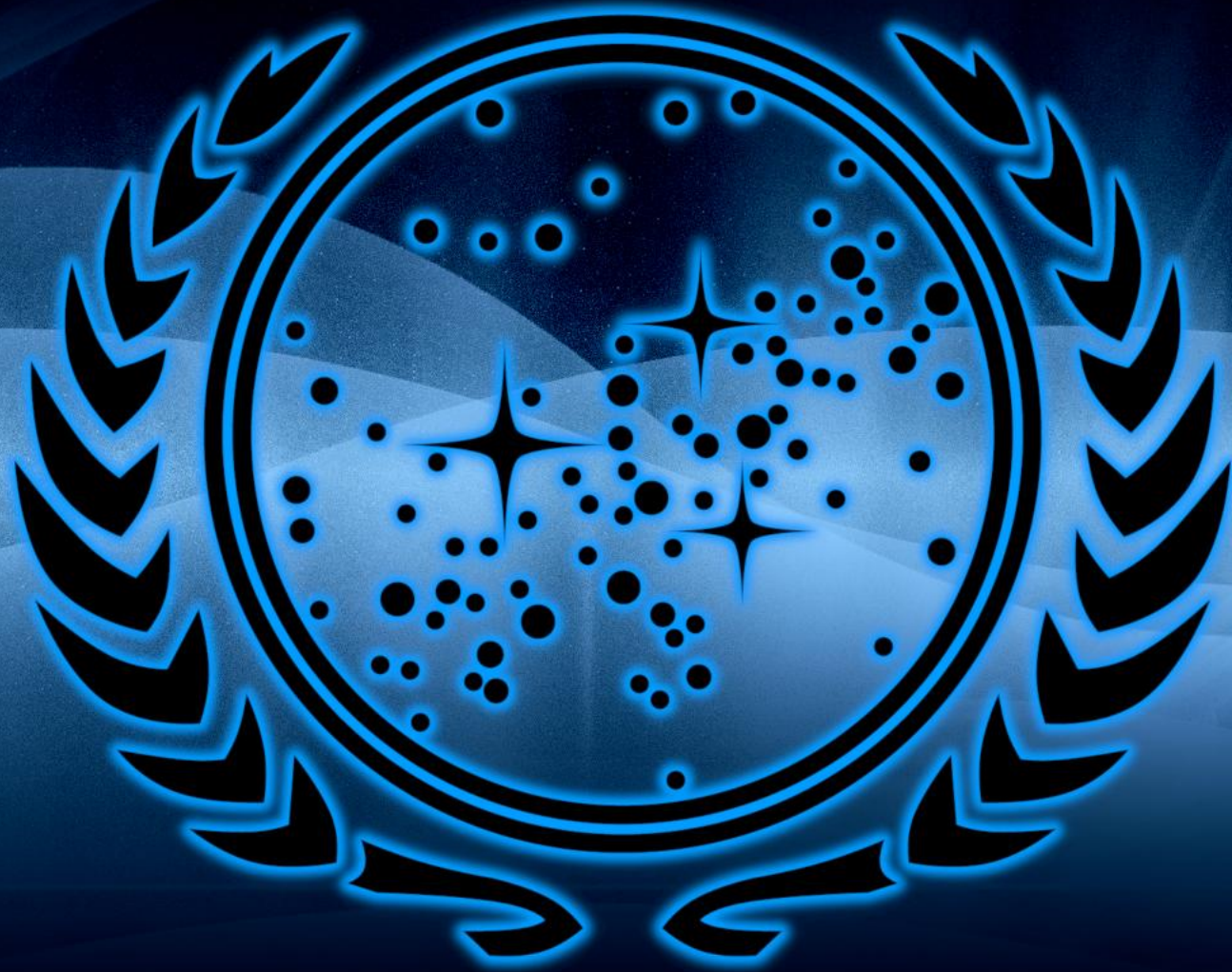
A woman is shown in profile, holding a vintage videophone receiver to her ear. The device has a small, rounded screen displaying a man's face. The background is a dark, textured surface. The text is overlaid on the left side of the image.

Videophones
Jetpacks
Flying cars
Airships
Utopian cities
World peace
Post-scarcity





Space planes & tourists
Space stations & hotels
Cities in space
Moonbases
Robots
Artificial intelligence
The Metaverse



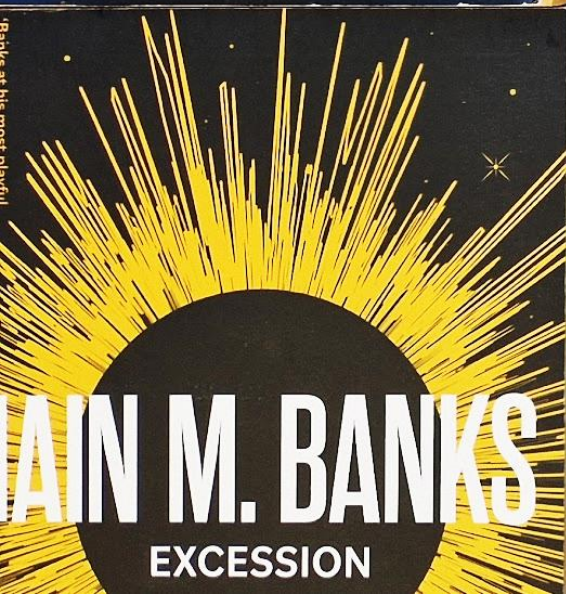
CONSIDER PHLEBAS

a novel



IAIN M. BANKS

author of *The Wasp Factory*



IAIN M. BANKS

EXCESSION

"The best tale of the Culture yet" INTERZONE



IAIN M. BANKS



IAIN M. BANKS

'Violently clever' Guardian

INVERSIONS



THE PLAYER OF GAMES

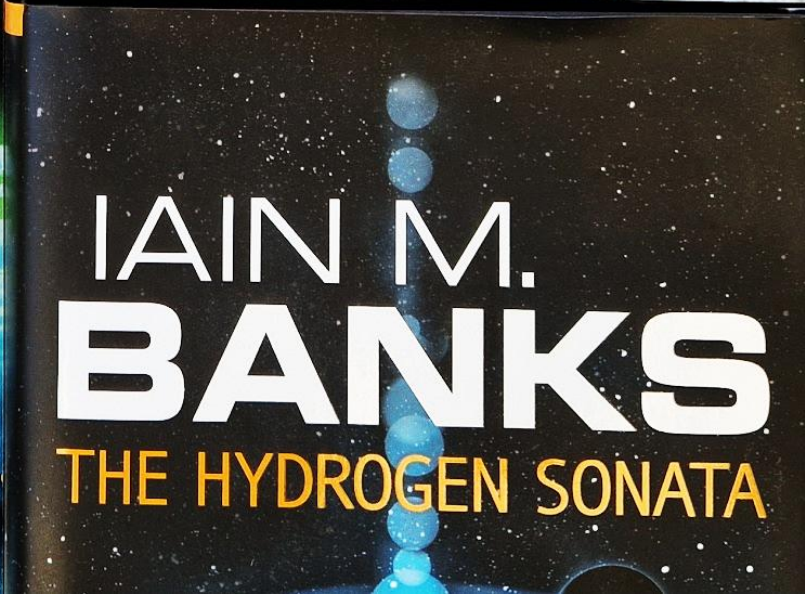


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Author of *THE WASP FACTORY*
and *CONSIDER PHLEBAS*

IAIN M. BANKS

THE HYDROGEN SONATA

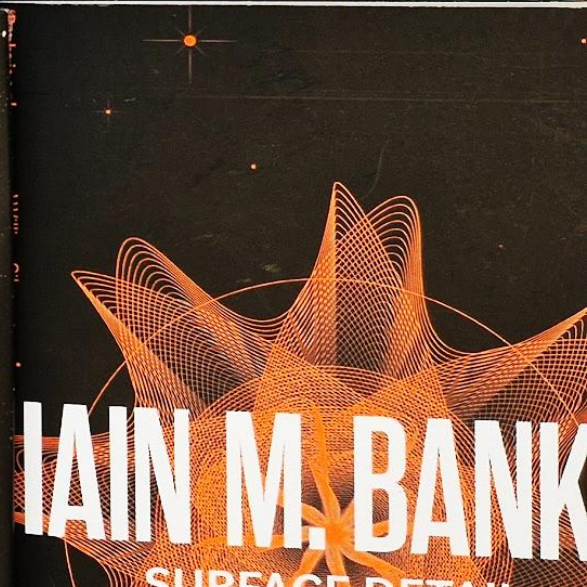


LOOK TO WINDWARD



IAIN M. BANKS

SURFACE DETAIL



CONSIDER
PHLEBAS
a novel



THE CULTURE

IAIN M. BANKS
author of *The Wasp Factory*



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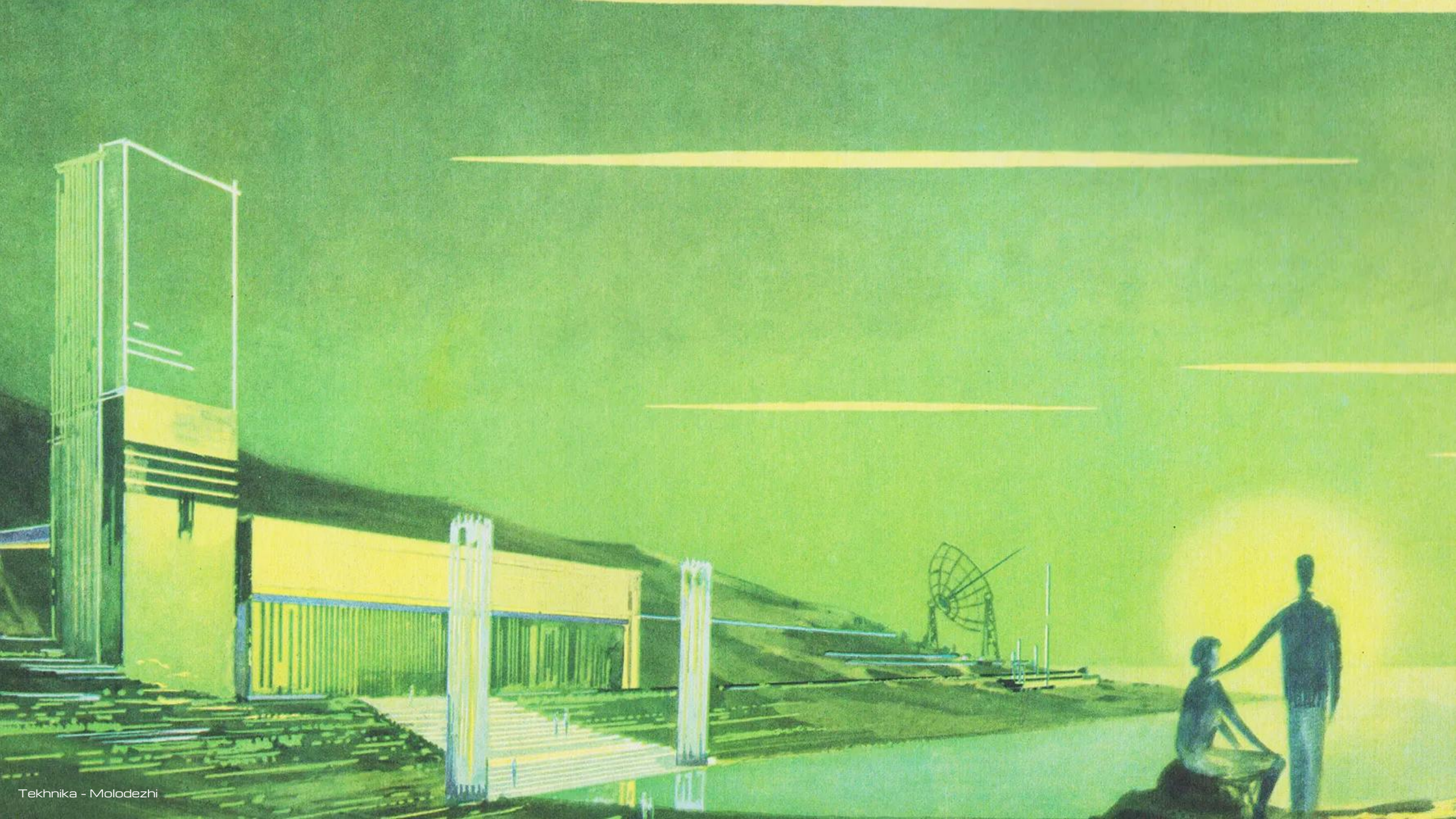


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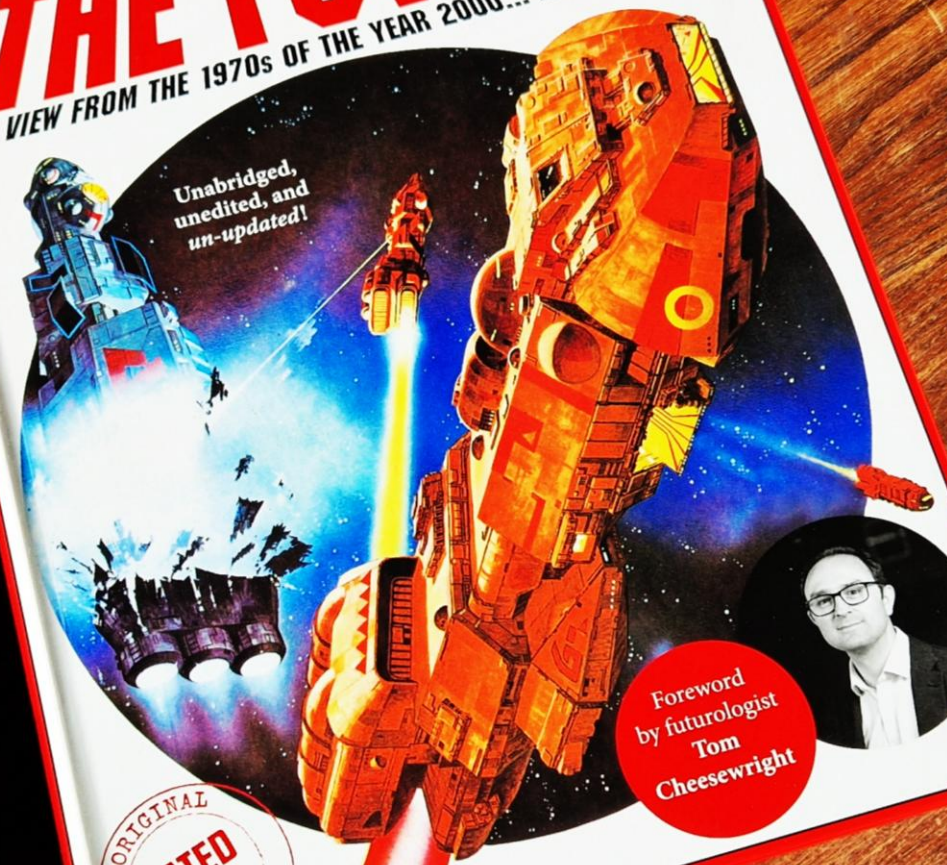
IAIN M. BANKS
SURFACE DETAIL





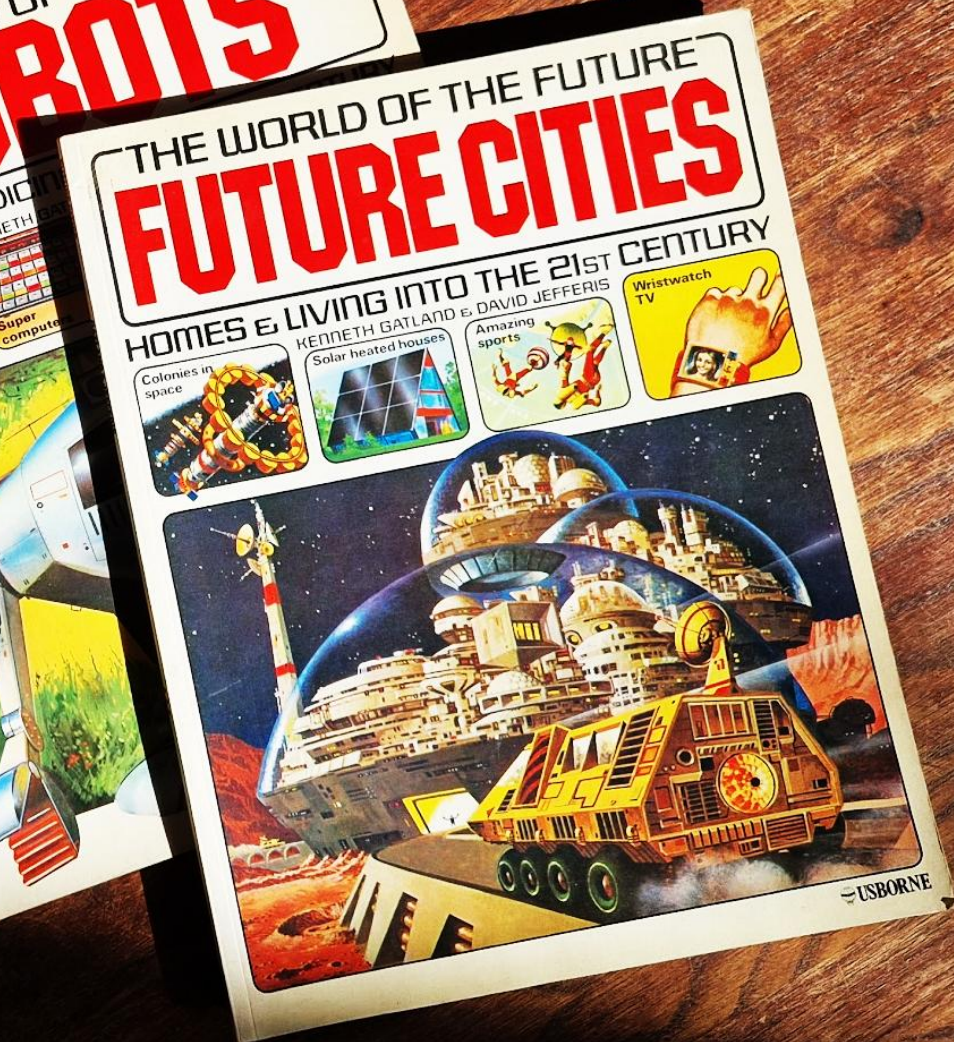
THE USBORNE BOOK OF
THE FUTURE
A VIEW FROM THE 1970s OF THE YEAR 2000... AND BEYOND

Unabridged,
unedited,
un-updated!

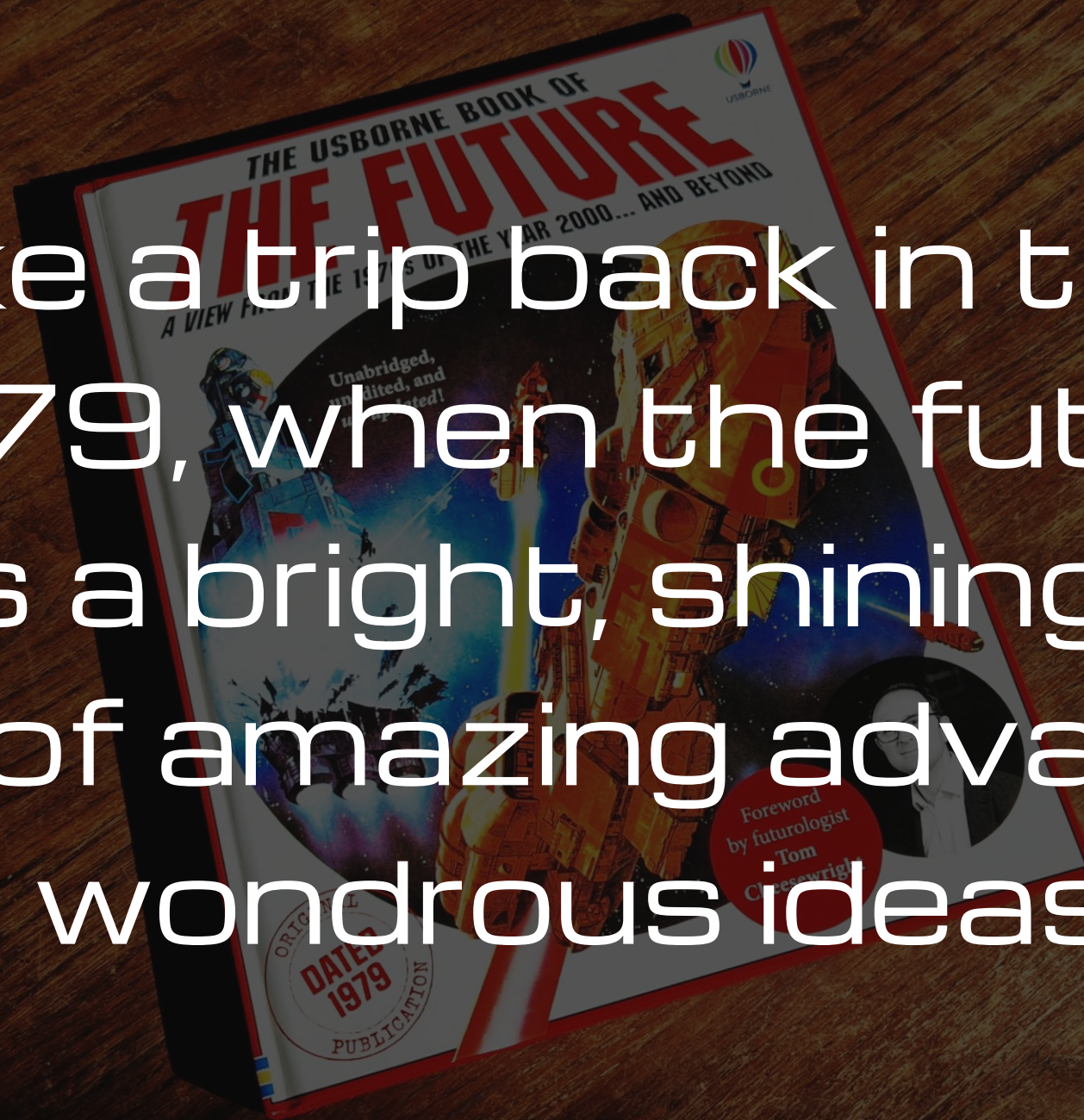


Foreword
by futurologist
Tom
Cheesewright

ORIGINAL
**DATED
1979**
PUBLICATION



Take a trip back in time to 1979, when the future was a bright, shining place, full of amazing advances and wondrous ideas.



THE NEXT 120 YEARS: A TIMECHART

Visionaries of the late 19th and early 20th centuries like Jules Verne and H. G. Wells predicted many of the inventions which have since changed the world, including submarines, aeroplanes, spacecraft and trips to the Moon.

Even bigger changes can be expected in the next 100 years. Provided that a major atomic war can be avoided, the foreseeable future is likely to be very exciting.

Here are just some of the things which might happen, most of them within your lifetime.

1980-1990



Space telescope launched by Space Shuttle into Earth orbit. The 13 metre-long telescope enables astronomers to view stars seven times further away and 50 times fainter than possible using telescopes on Earth.

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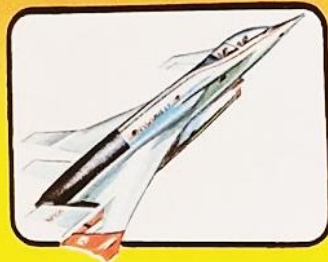
Solar power plants set up in the Middle East to help provide cheap power for farmers.

Girder-beam building equipment tested in orbit; demonstrates ability to construct huge structures.

Experimental nuclear-fusion power station generates electricity successfully.

Orbital space station demonstrates that many industrial processes are cheaper and better carried out in space.

1991-2000



HiMAT-type fighters in service. Some equipped with robot pilots, flying automatically and able to fly tougher and longer missions than human pilots.

High-power lasers become standard issue on the battlefield, replacing many guns and cannon.

Reign of the robot draws near as the machine functions of vision, movement, manipulation and 'thinking' are steadily improved.

Earthquake detector flown into orbit by Space Shuttle. Used to check the unstable San Andreas fault in California, USA.

Fire-fighting machines equipped with robot command systems used in the USA to help combat forest fires.

Microcell surgery – the ability to destroy individual diseased cells in the body using laser beams – is widely practised in hospitals.

Undersea fish farms built to improve fish stocks in the oceans.

Computer systems are developed which learn from their mistakes like humans.

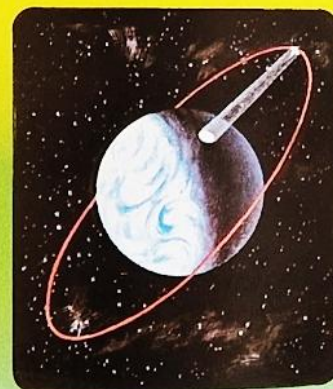
High-speed hovercraft troop-carrier, replace most ordinary assault craft in the world's navies.

Genetic engineering, the artificial



Industrial robots increasingly take over the jobs of skilled engineers in factories.

The Replicator is developed. The device can make practically anything using material from chemicals stored nearby. The complex instructions required are masterminded by computer; laser beams place atoms and molecules into position to build any object.



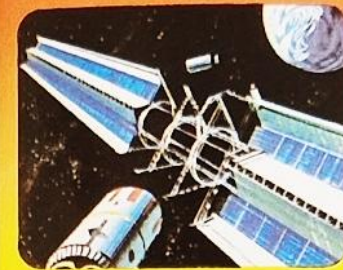
Space mirrors placed in orbit to provide night-lighting on Earth. Uses of the sunlight-reflecting mirrors include city lighting and as floodlights in emergency situations like earthquake relief work.

2001-2050

First nuclear-fusion power station goes into commercial service in the USA. Obtains power from deuterium extracted from sea water.

OF FUTURE SCIENTIFIC POSSIBILITIES

Micro-processor mini-robot implanted in human brain. Machine helps stroke victims regain the use of their arms and legs, replacing the lost nerves.



Robots and astronauts construct first Satellite Solar Power Station in orbit. The SSPS beams a continuous beam of microwave energy to receiving stations on Earth.

Fusion power converted into microwave energy; 'exported' to other countries using a relay satellite to beam the microwaves around the world.

Men return to the Moon for the first time since 1973. This time they are surveyors, prospecting for the best site for a Moonmining colony.



Robot mining equipment landed on the Moon to extract metals from rock.

Robot survey craft lands on an asteroid to check its mineral worth. Giant radio-telescope placed into Earth orbit. Its task – to search for signs of other life in the Universe, intelligent life which might be broadcasting radio signals.



Asteroids used as source of mineral wealth. Small mining colonies in the Asteroid Belt are the start of an 'Outer Solar System' human civilization.

2051-2099



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Jupiter's atmosphere mined with robot controlled balloon stations. Materials used by the human colonies now based in Earth orbit, on the Moon, Mars, and in the Asteroid Belt.

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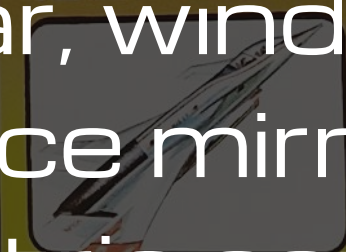


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Even bigger changes are expected in the next 100 years. Provided that a major atomic war can be avoided, a more resplendent future is likely than the one we have now. Here are just a few of the changes which might happen, most of them within your lifetime.

1991-2000



Some equipped with robot pilots, flying automatically and able to fly tougher and longer missions than human pilots.

High-speed hovercraft troop-carriers become standard issue on the battlefield, replacing many guns and cannon.

Earthquake detector flown into orbit by space shuttle. Used to track back the unsinkable Andromeda galaxy.

Fire-fighting machines equipped with robot command systems used in the USA to fight fires in the city.

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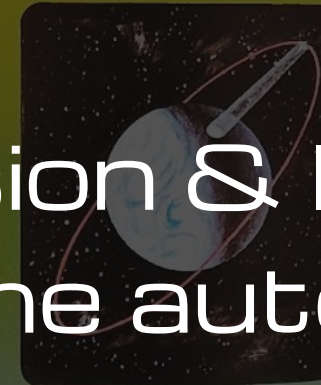
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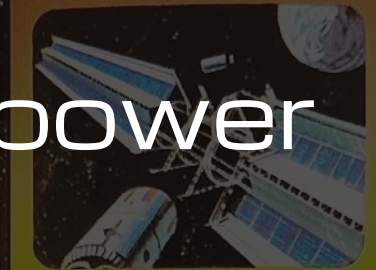
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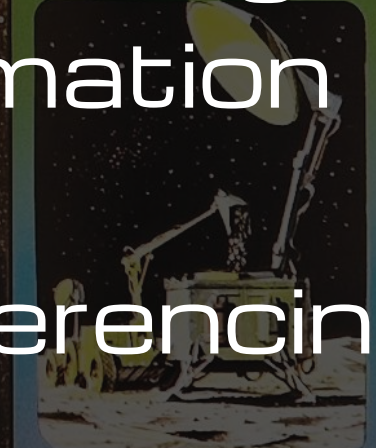
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Men return to the Moon for the first time since 1972. This time they are to stay for a long time, to best the record for a Moon landing.



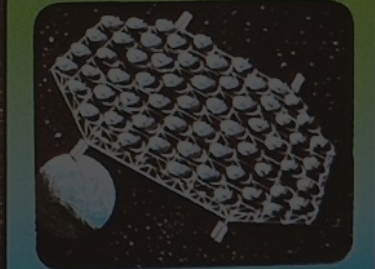
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Experiments in nuclear fusion power generation produce electricity successfully. One of the advantages of fusion is that many industrial processes are cheaper and better carried out in space.

1991-2000



Industrial robots increasingly take over the jobs of skilled engineers in factories.

The office machine is developed. The office machine practically anything using material from chemicals stored nearby. The complex instructions required are made permanent on computer tapes. The machine begins to assemble and disassemble in position to build any object.

1980-1990



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Some equipped with robot pilots, flying automatically and able to fly tougher and longer missions than human pilots. The standard issue on the battlefield, replacing many guns and cannon.

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Earthquake detector flown into orbit by Space Shuttle. Used to detect the causes of San Francisco earthquake in the USA.

Fire-fighting machines equipped with robot command systems used in the USA to battle fires in the city of Los Angeles. The machines destroy individual diseased cells in the body using laser beams - is widely practised in hospitals.

Undersea fish farms built to produce fish for food in the sea.

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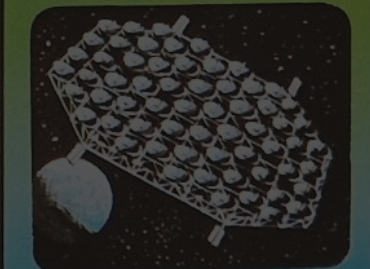
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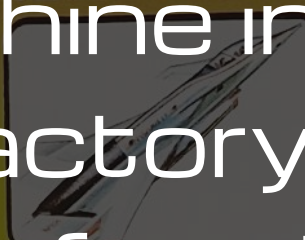
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All types of fields in service. Some equipped with robot pilots, flying automatically and able to fly tougher and longer missions than human pilots. Used as standard issue on the battlefield, replacing many guns and cannon.

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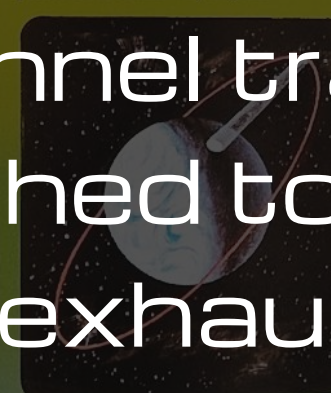
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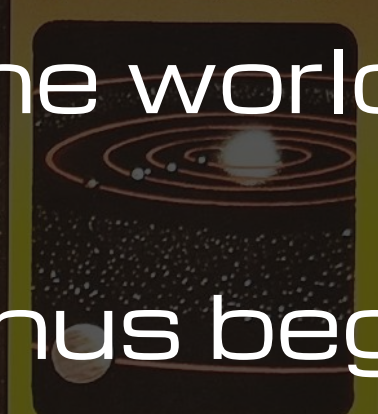
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LOS ANGELES

NOVEMBER, 2019







The 90s were such a remarkable time, an exciting time to be alive. It was a lot more loose. There was a sense of innocence. The Soviet Union was gone. Climate change wasn't on 99% of people's minds and the big scandal was Bill Clinton having an extramarital affair.

Darren Aronofsky

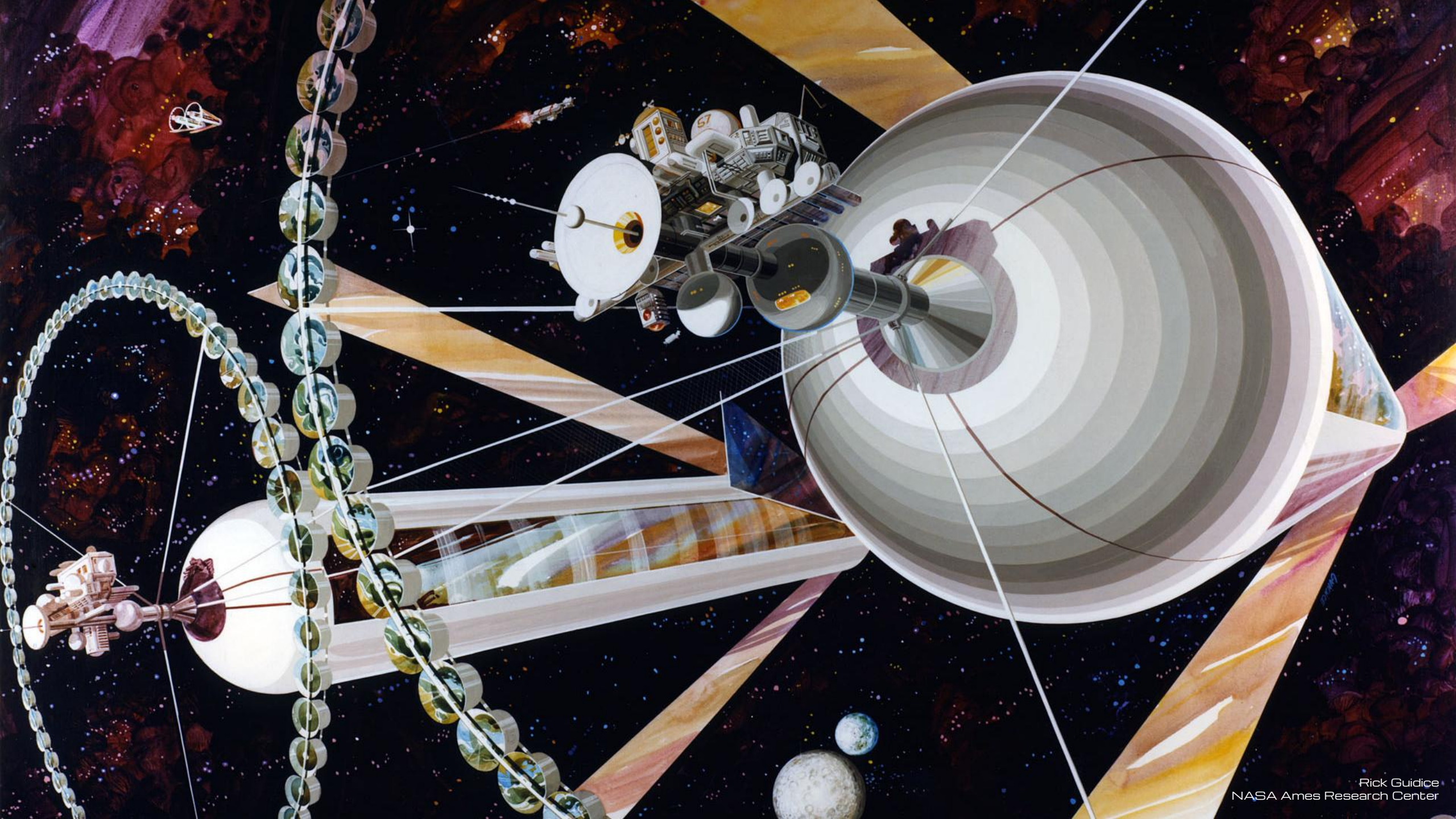
theguardian.com/film/2025/aug/25/darren-aronofsky-memes-gags-ai-caught-stealing-tiktok-google-deepmind

People were looking forward to the new millennium. It was going to be The Jetsons. It was going to be sci-fi.

We weren't all living in a state of existential terror.

Darren Aronofsky

theguardian.com/film/2025/aug/25/darren-aronofsky-memes-gags-ai-caught-stealing-tiktok-google-deepmind





THE WAY THE FUTURE IS

James & Kevlin

Sci-Fi Author: In my book I invented the
Torment Nexus as a cautionary tale

Tech Company: At long last, we have
created the Torment Nexus from
classic sci-fi novel *Don't Create The
Torment Nexus*

Alex Blechman

WHO WAS THE FUTURE FOR?

It was for all

WHO *IS* THE FUTURE FOR?

It is for a few

DYSTOPIAN OUTLOOK

In fiction, fact & futures





JEVONS PARADOX

Increased efficiency $\Rightarrow$
Increased consumption

How Deepseek provides a perfect example of the Jevons Paradox



Enrique Dans

Follow

4 min read · Jan 29, 2025



990



13

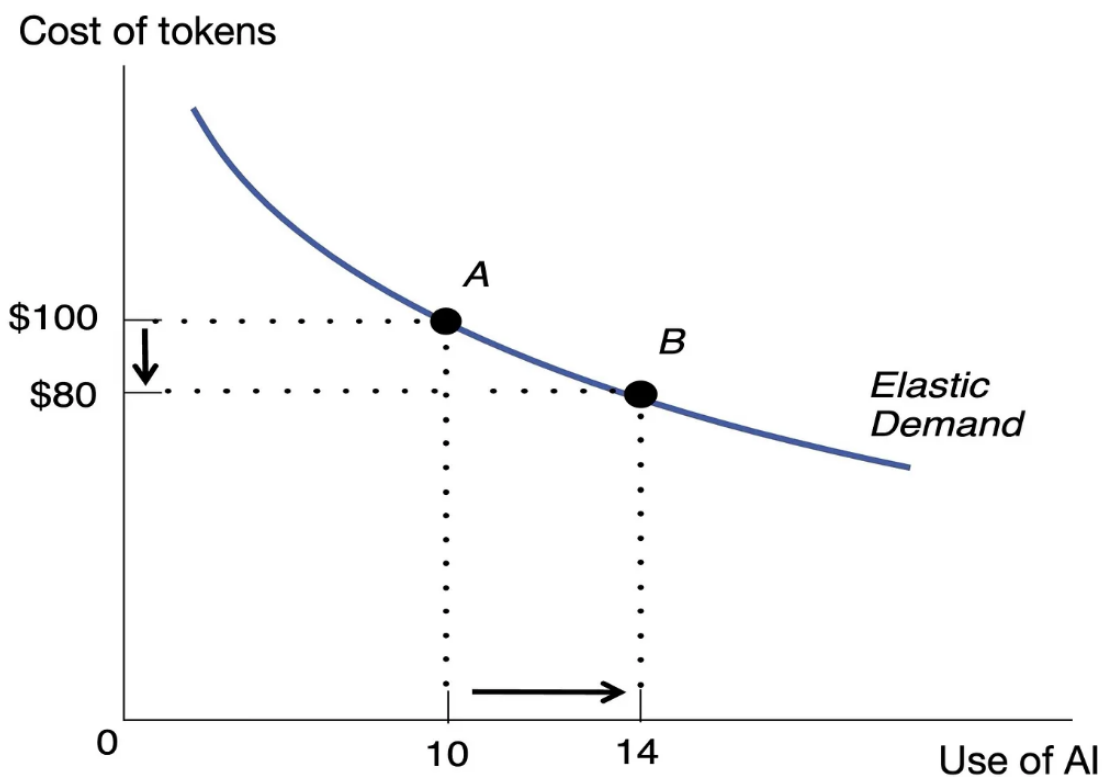
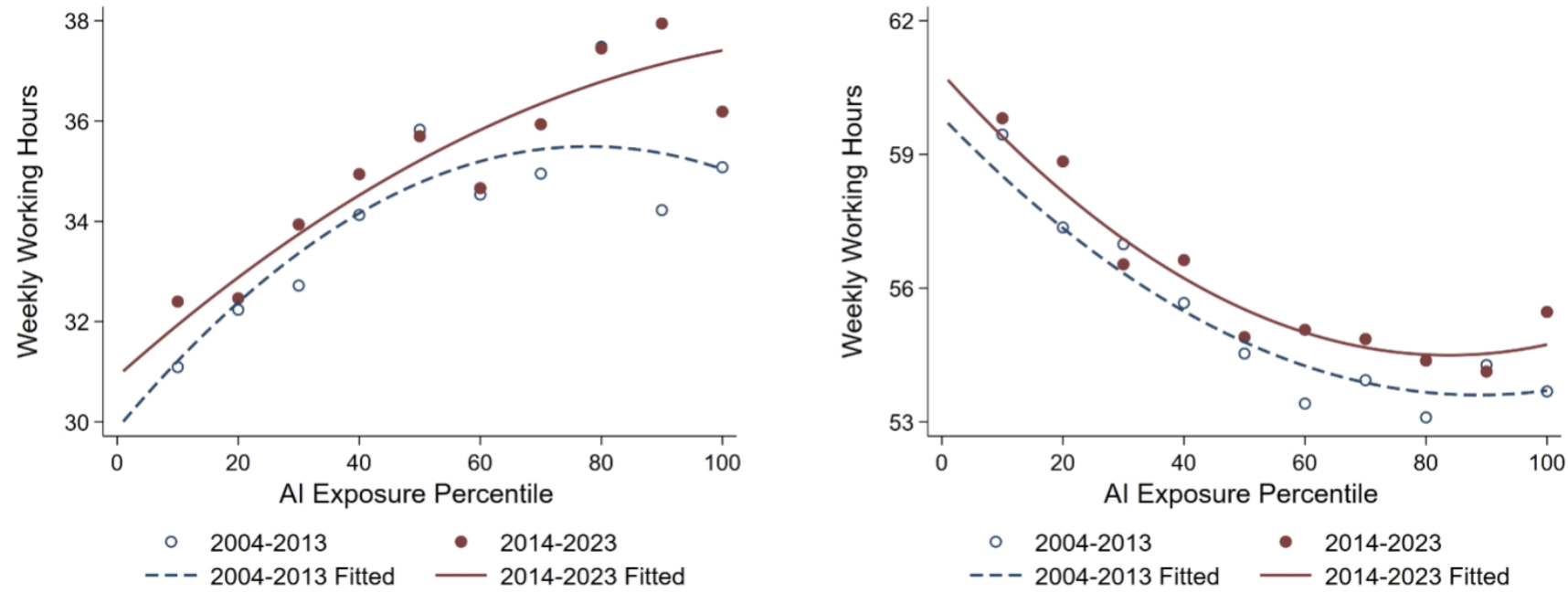


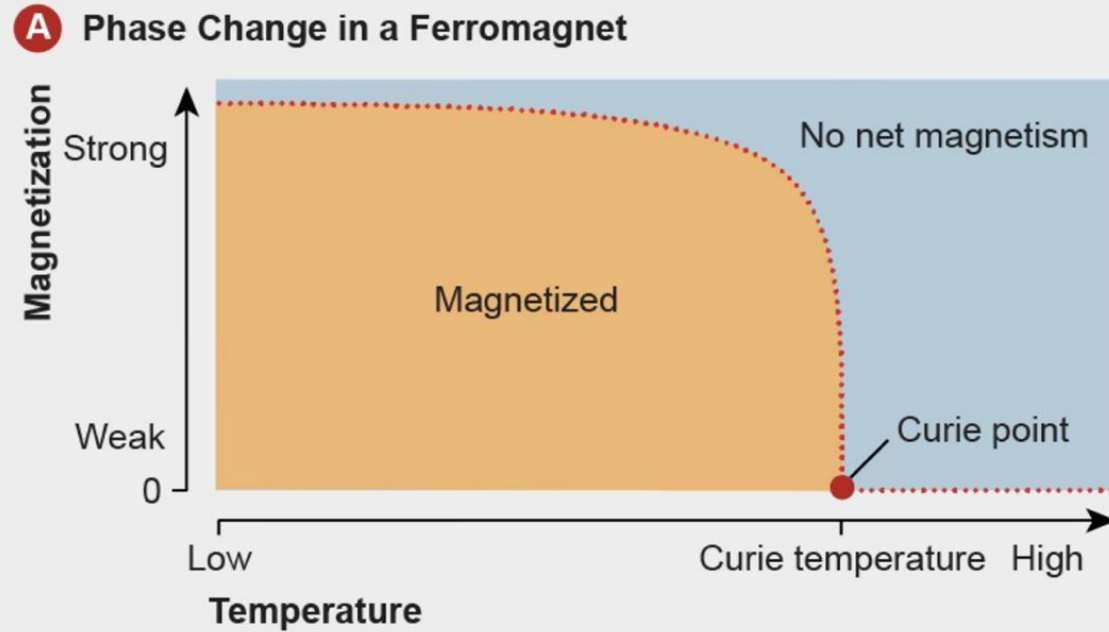
IMAGE: Modified from Jevons paradox — Lawrencekhoo (BB BY-SA)

Figure 2 Weekly working hours and AI exposure



The introduction of ChatGPT provides an unexpected shock to generative AI adoption and serves as a natural experiment (Hui et al. 2023). Occupations more exposed to generative AI saw a rise in work hours immediately following the release of ChatGPT. Compared to workers less exposed to generative AI (such as tire

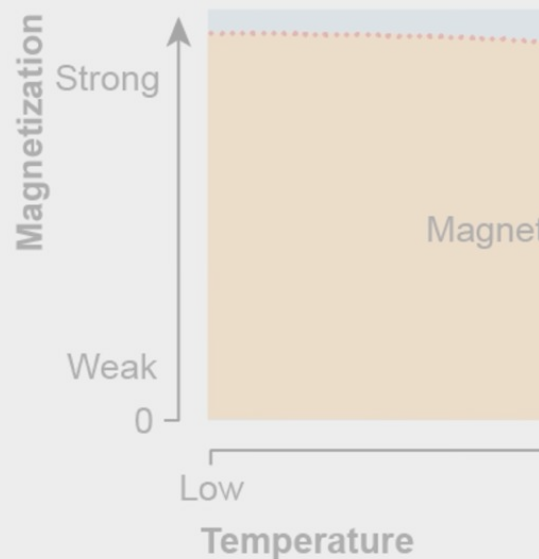
T_C .) That is, magnetization shows up suddenly, with the direction of the magnetization being random (or, more precisely, dependent on microscopic fluctuations beyond our idealization of the ferromagnet as a continuous macroscopic system).



Economic systems can also exhibit phase transitions. When the wealth-bias parameter ζ of the affine wealth model is less than the redistribution parameter χ , the wealth distribution is not even partially

T_C .) That is, magnetization shows up suddenly, with the direction of the magnetization being random (or, more precisely, dependent on microscopic fluctuations beyond our idealization of the ferromagnet as a continuous macroscopic system).

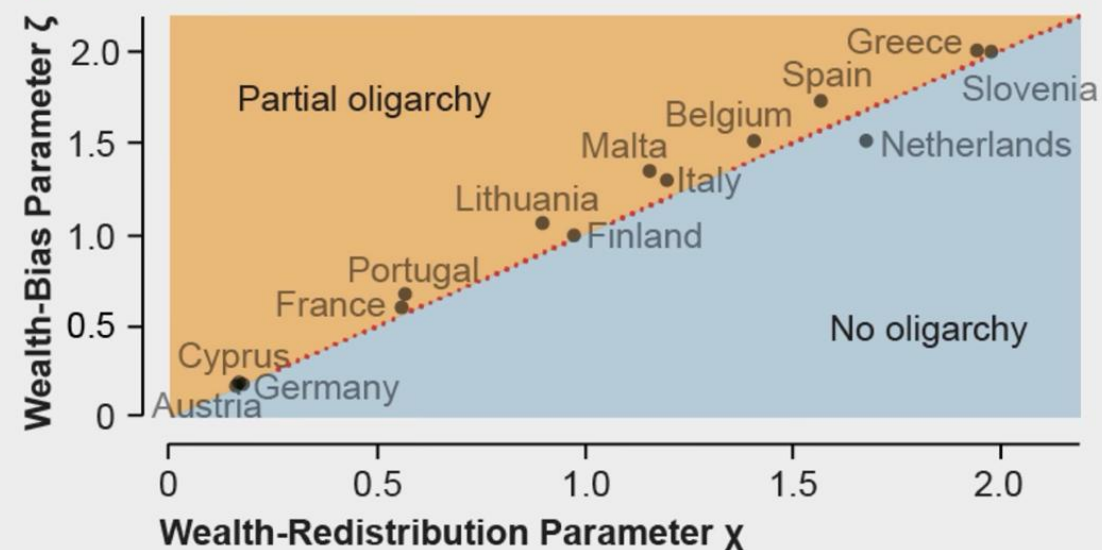
A Phase Change in a Ferromagnet



Significantly, most countries are very close to criticality. A plot of 14 of the countries served by the European Central Bank in the χ - ζ plane in **B** shows that most lie near the diagonal. All except one (the Netherlands) lie just above the diagonal, indicating that they are just slightly oligarchical. It may be that inequality naturally increases until oligarchies begin to form, at which point political pressures set in, preventing further reduction of equality.

Economic systems can also exhibit phase transition. In the wealth model, if the redistribution parameter is less than the redistribution parameter

B Phase Transition in Economic Systems



Von Neumann machines

Probably only humans find the idea of Von Neumann machines frightening, because we half-understand – and even partially relate to – the obsessiveness of the ethos such constructs embody.

Iain M Banks

vavatch.co.uk/books/banks/cultnote.htm

An AI would think the idea
mad, ludicrous and – perhaps
most damning of all – boring.

Iain M Banks

vavatch.co.uk/books/banks/cultnote.htm

POST-SCARCITY

Everyone's basic needs
can be satisfied

We should have had a permanent human research station on the Moon by now. But I am also in awe of what we have accomplished because fifty years ago, nobody imagined that we would have confirmed the detection of thousands of planets orbiting other stars.

Julie Novakova

forbes.com/sites/brucedorminey/2025/09/10/how-science-fiction-drives-humanitys-present-and-future



The background image is a dark, atmospheric photograph of a modern city at night. Several tall skyscrapers are visible, their windows glowing with light. In the foreground, a large, illuminated globe sits on a plaza. The overall scene suggests a high-tech, global environment.

2025

Global satellite network
GPS

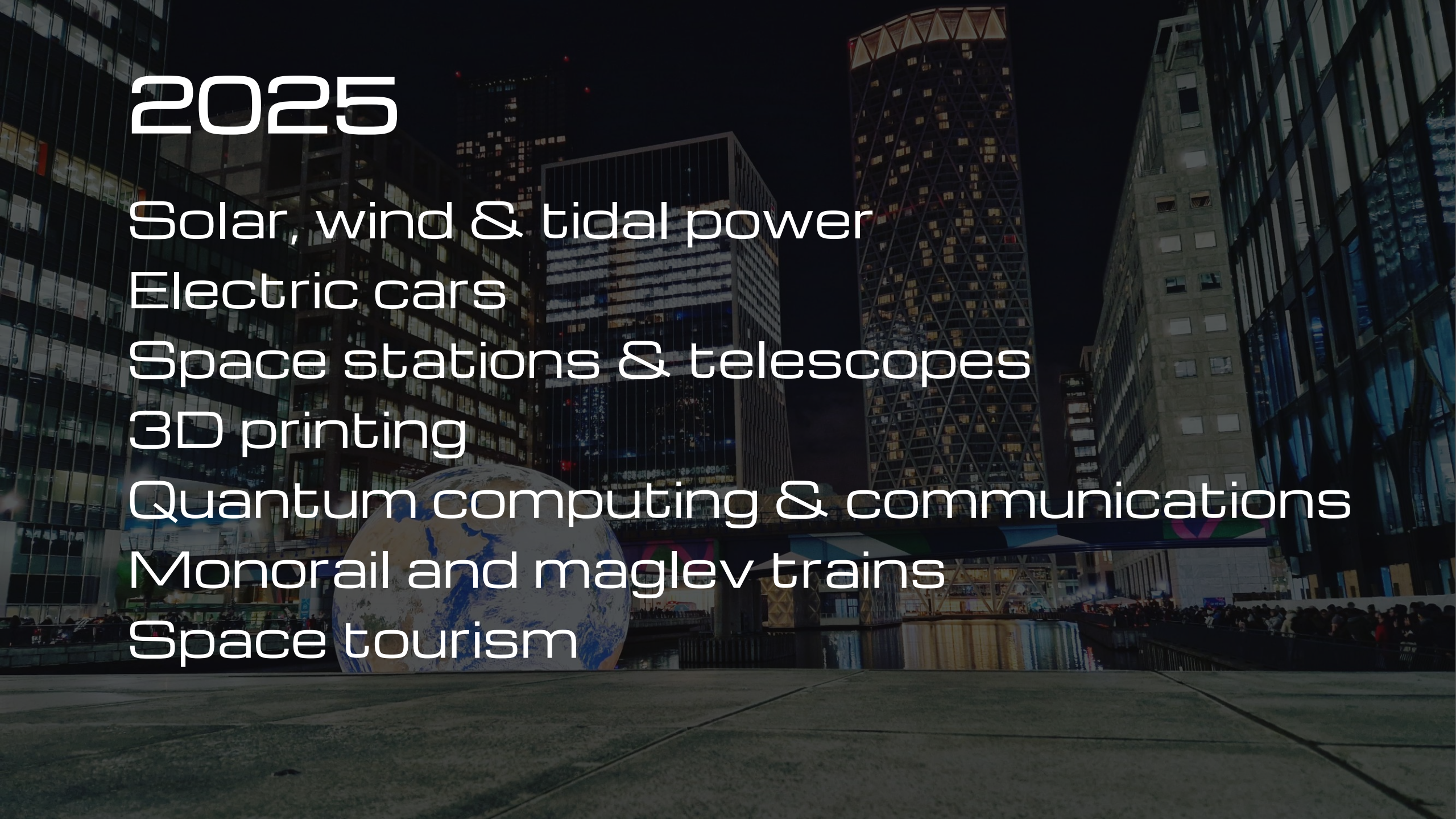
Artificial intelligence

Global information network

Handheld computing & communication

Videophones

Electronic money

A futuristic cityscape at night, featuring several tall, illuminated skyscrapers with glowing windows. In the foreground, a large, detailed globe of the Earth is visible. The scene is set in a modern urban environment with a paved plaza and a crowd of people in the distance.

2025

Solar, wind & tidal power

Electric cars

Space stations & telescopes

3D printing

Quantum computing & communications

Monorail and maglev trains

Space tourism

2025 (RIP)

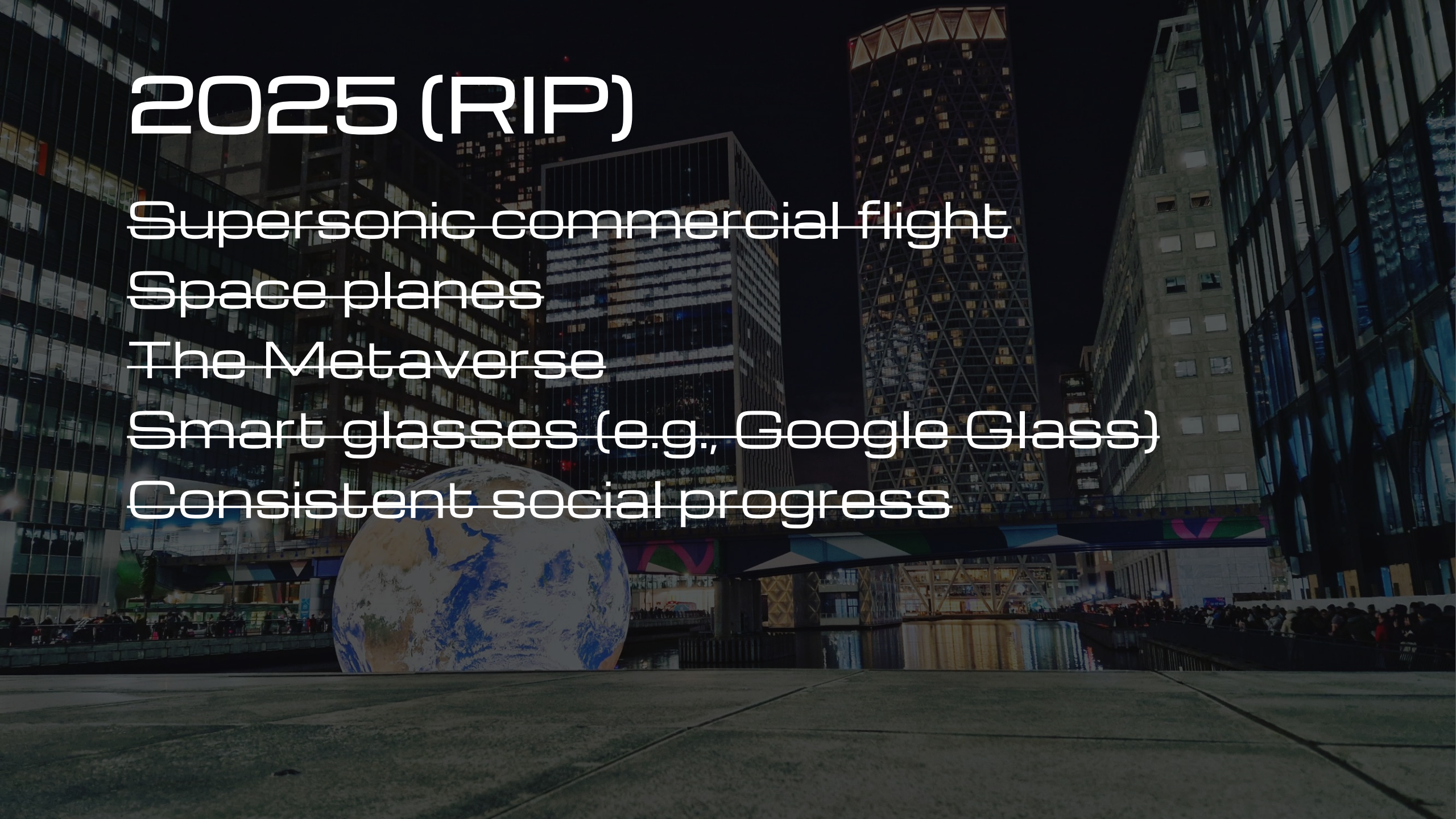
~~Supersonic commercial flight~~

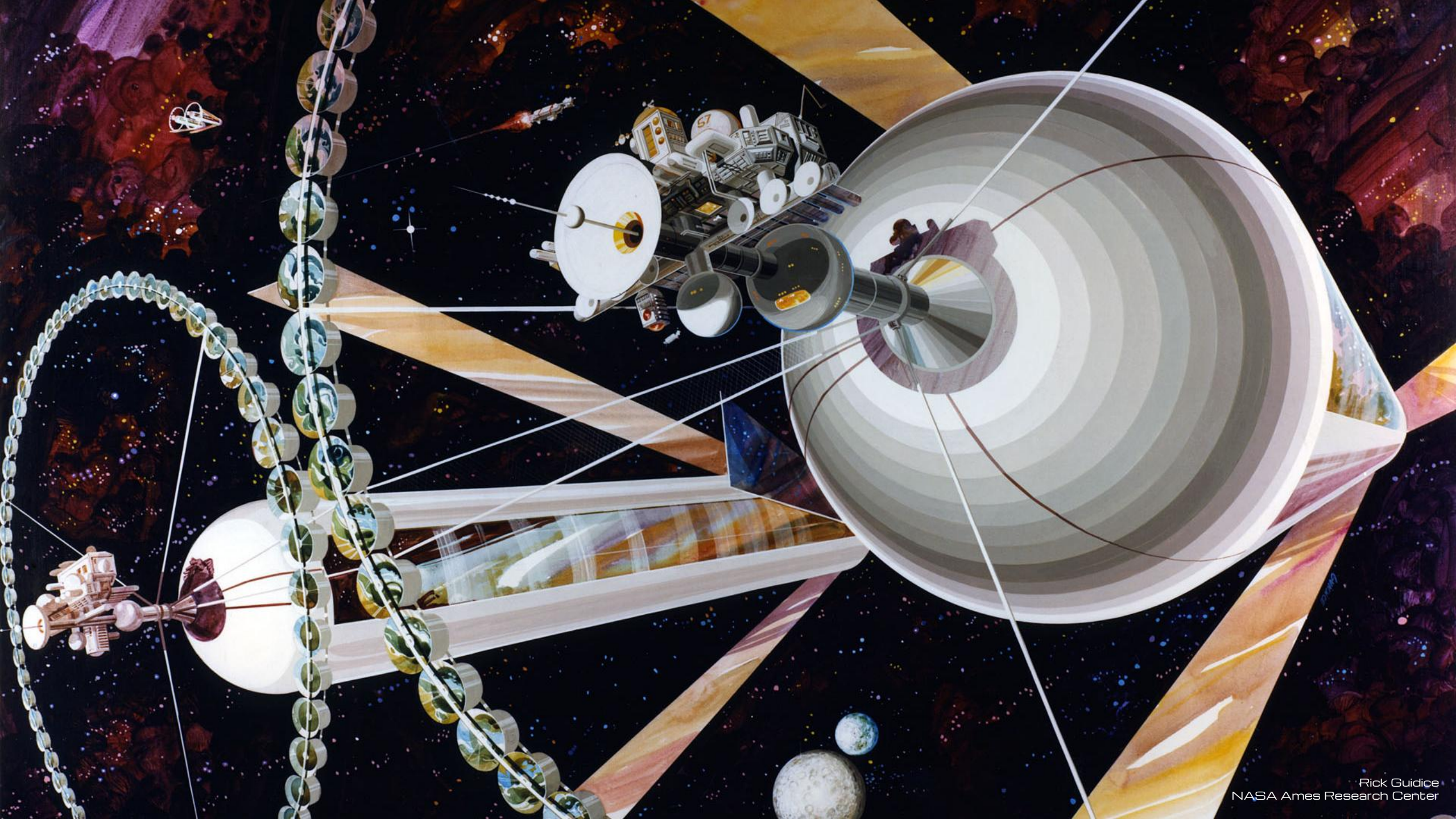
~~Space planes~~

~~The Metaverse~~

~~Smart glasses (e.g., Google Glass)~~

~~Consistent social progress~~



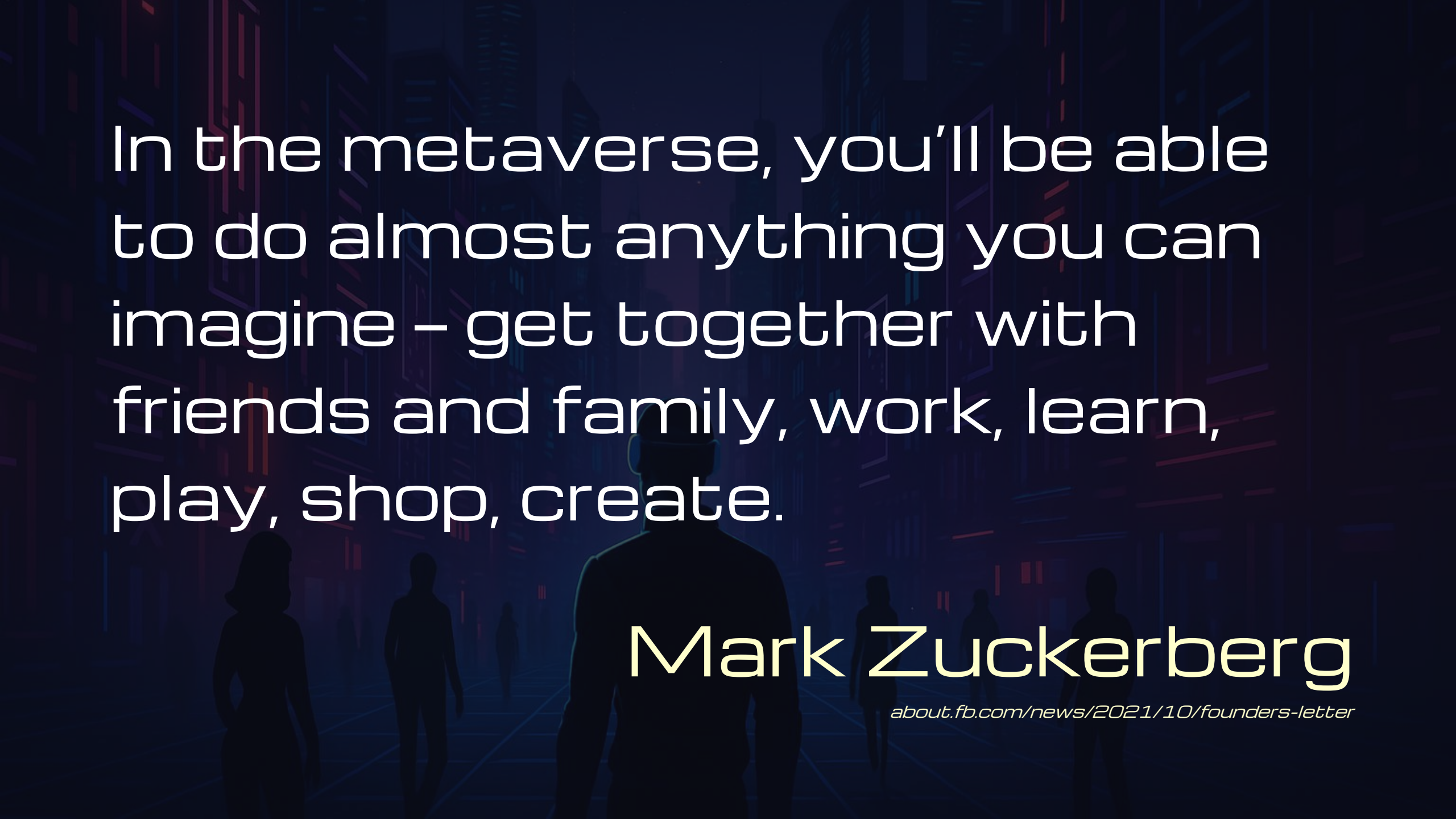




THE WAY THE FUTURE COMES TO BE

James & Kevlin





In the metaverse, you'll be able to do almost anything you can imagine – get together with friends and family, work, learn, play, shop, create.

Mark Zuckerberg

about.fb.com/news/2021/10/founders-letter

1992 Snowcrash

1991 World Wide Web

1994 Amazon

2003 Second Life

2002 Yahoo Messenger
MSN Messenger

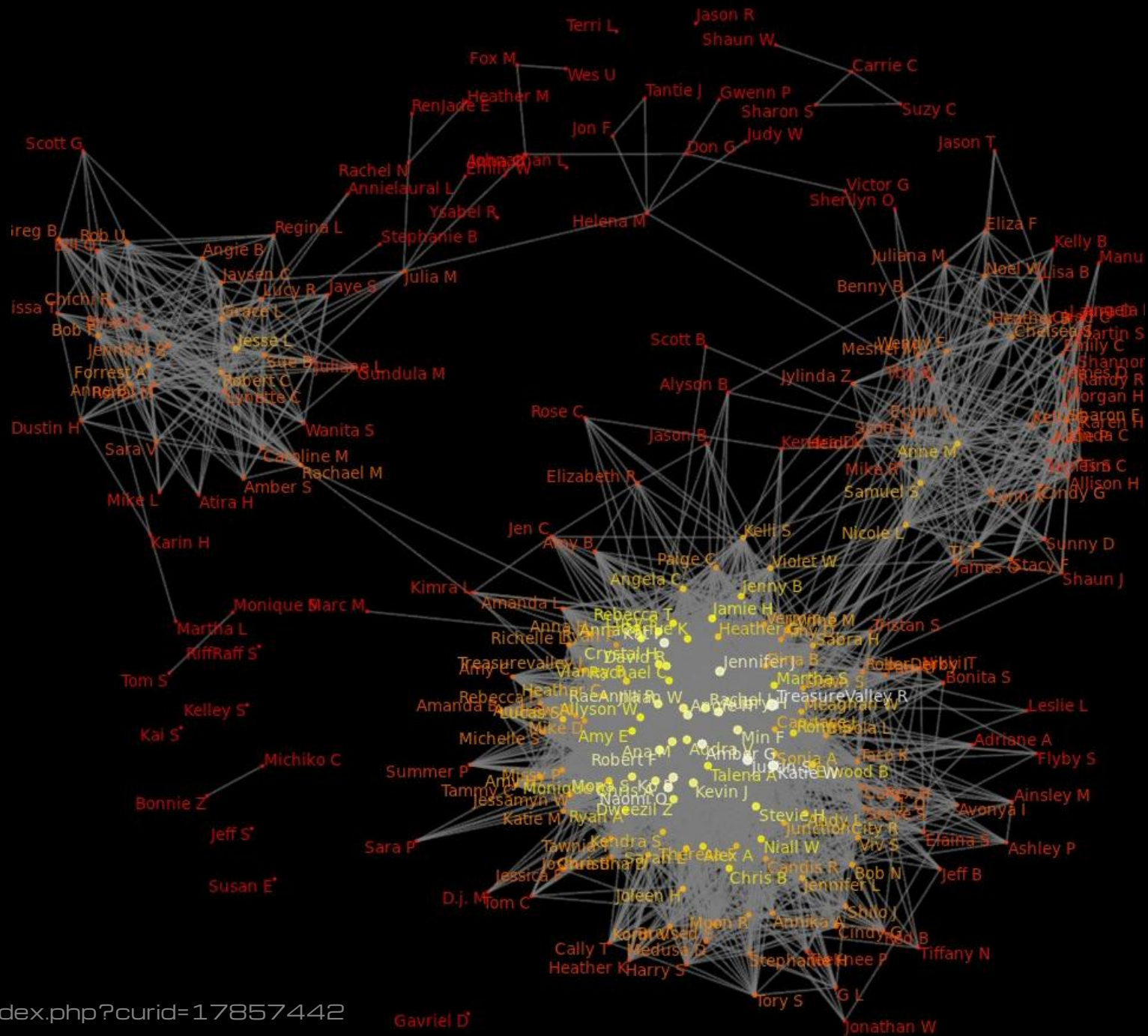
2005 Skype

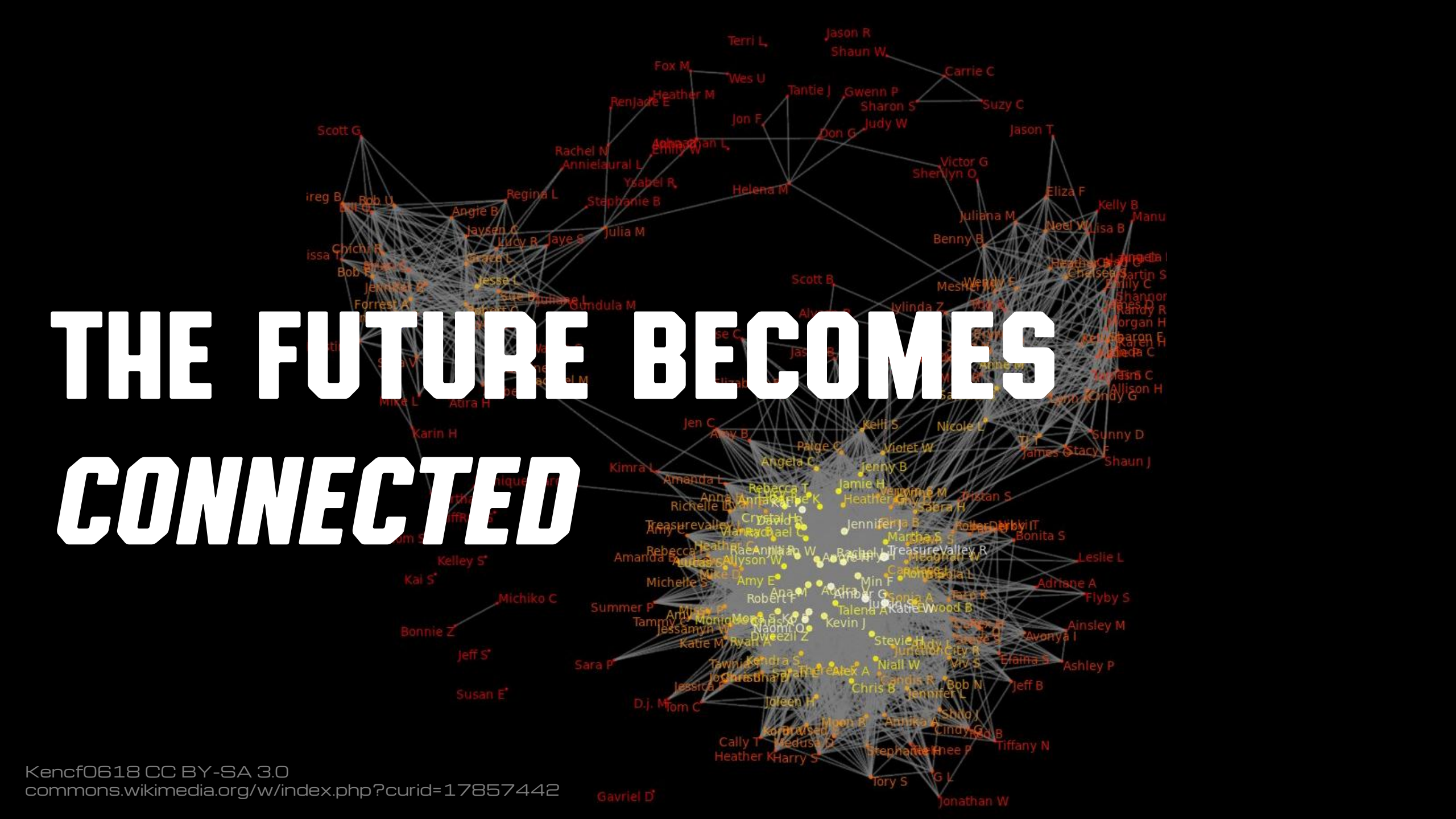
2010 FaceTime

"Videophone"

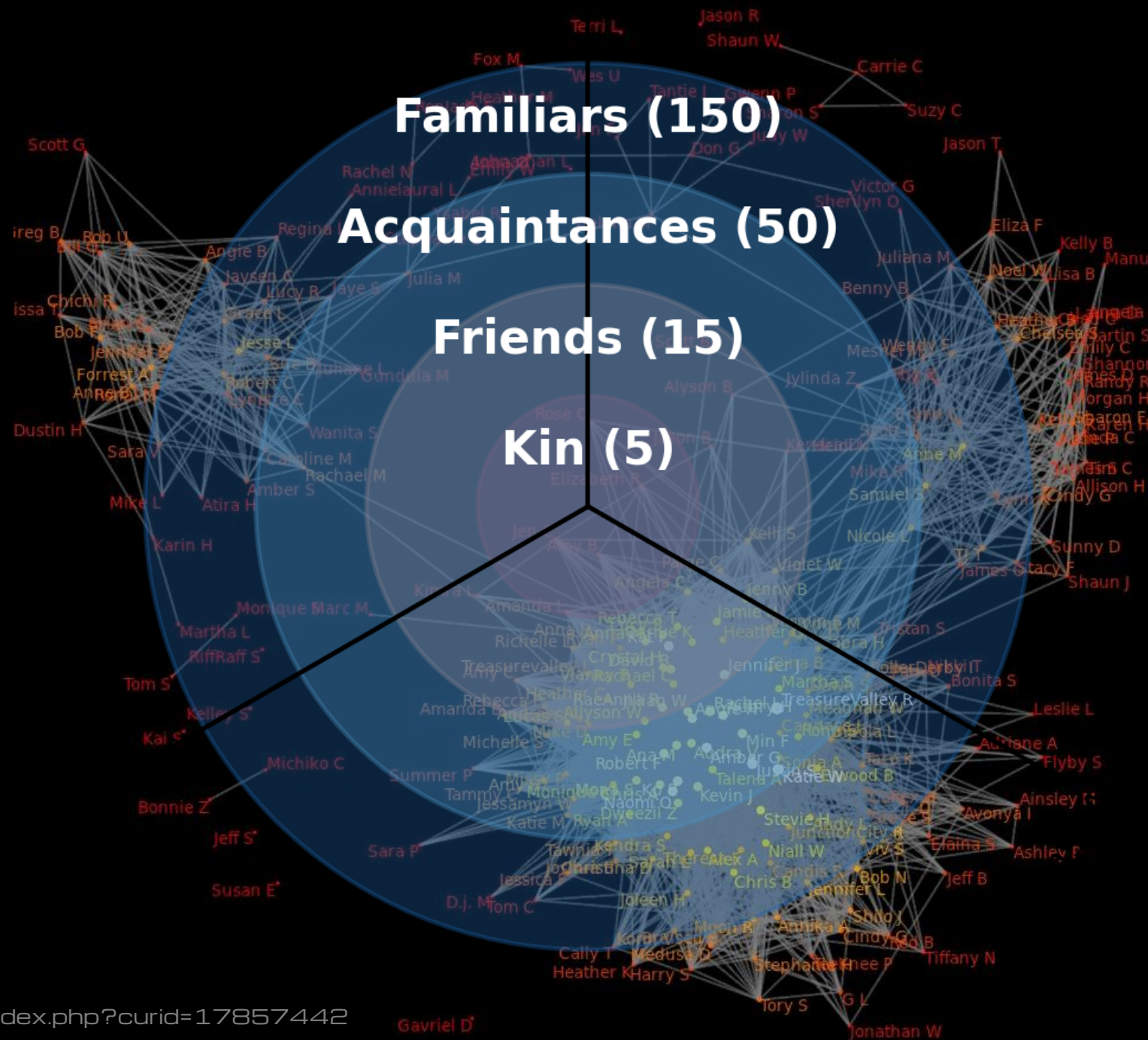
2021 Meta

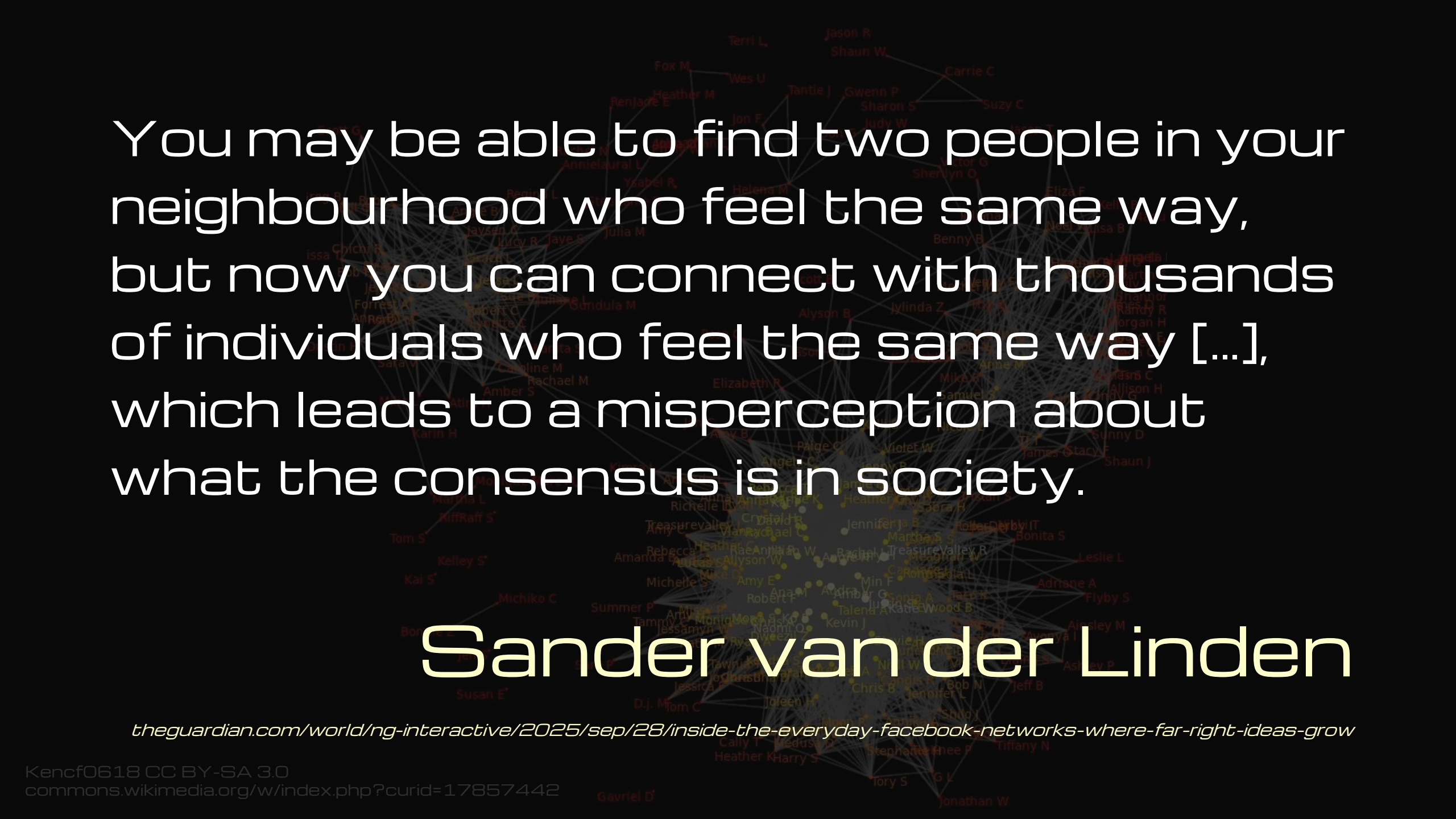
2020 Covid-19





THE FUTURE BECOMES *CONNECTED*

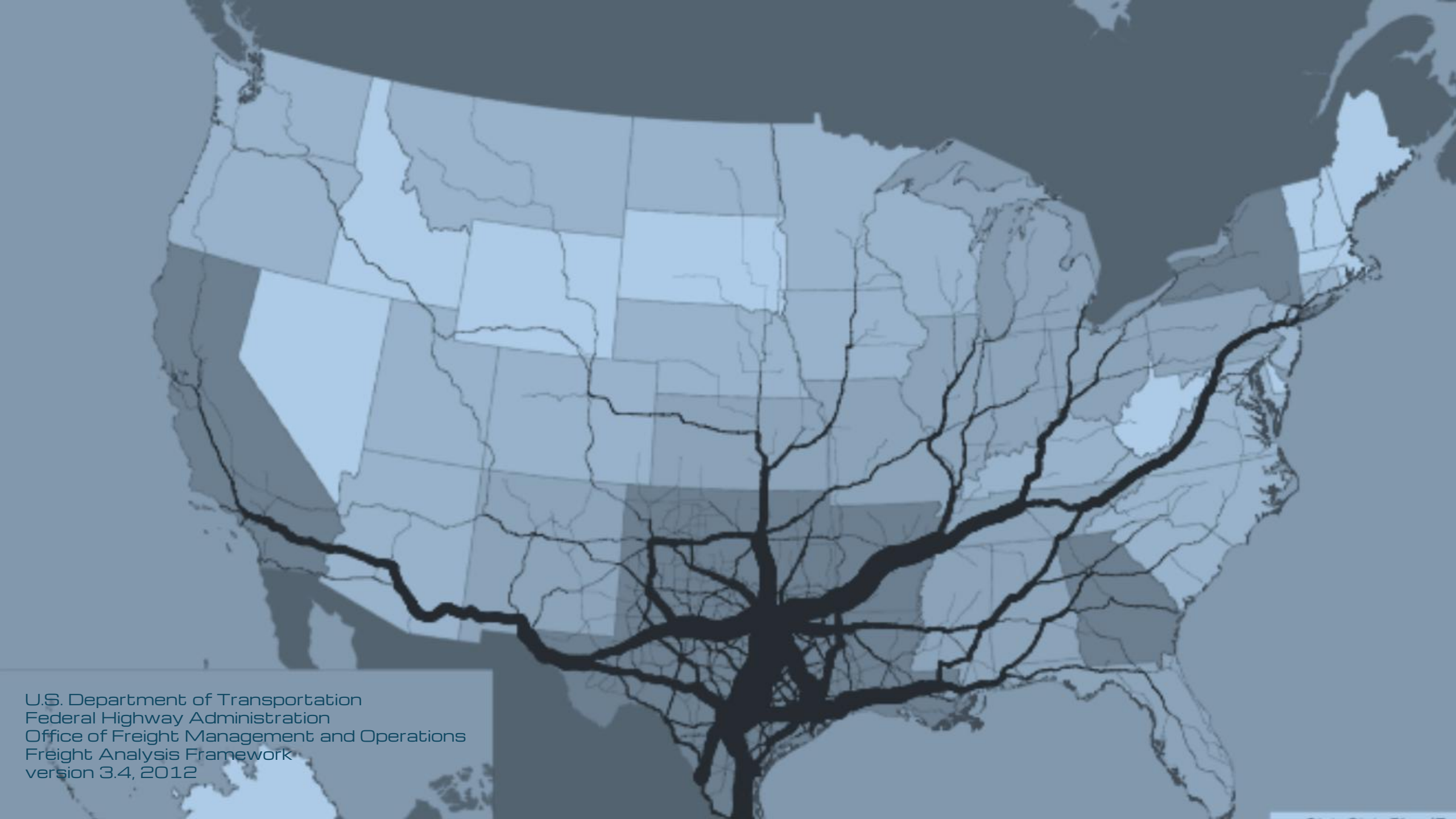


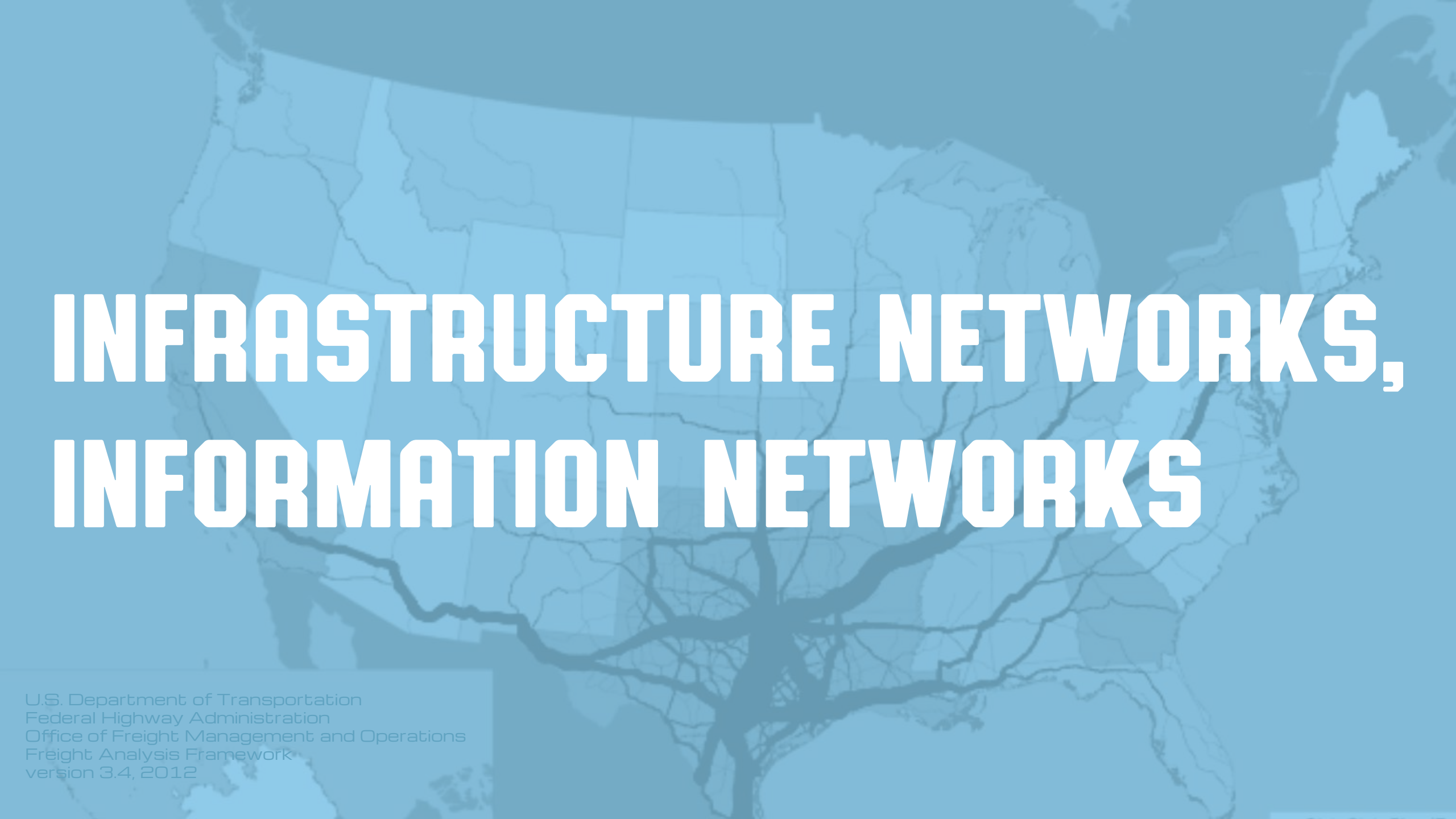


You may be able to find two people in your neighbourhood who feel the same way, but now you can connect with thousands of individuals who feel the same way [...], which leads to a misperception about what the consensus is in society.

Sander van der Linden

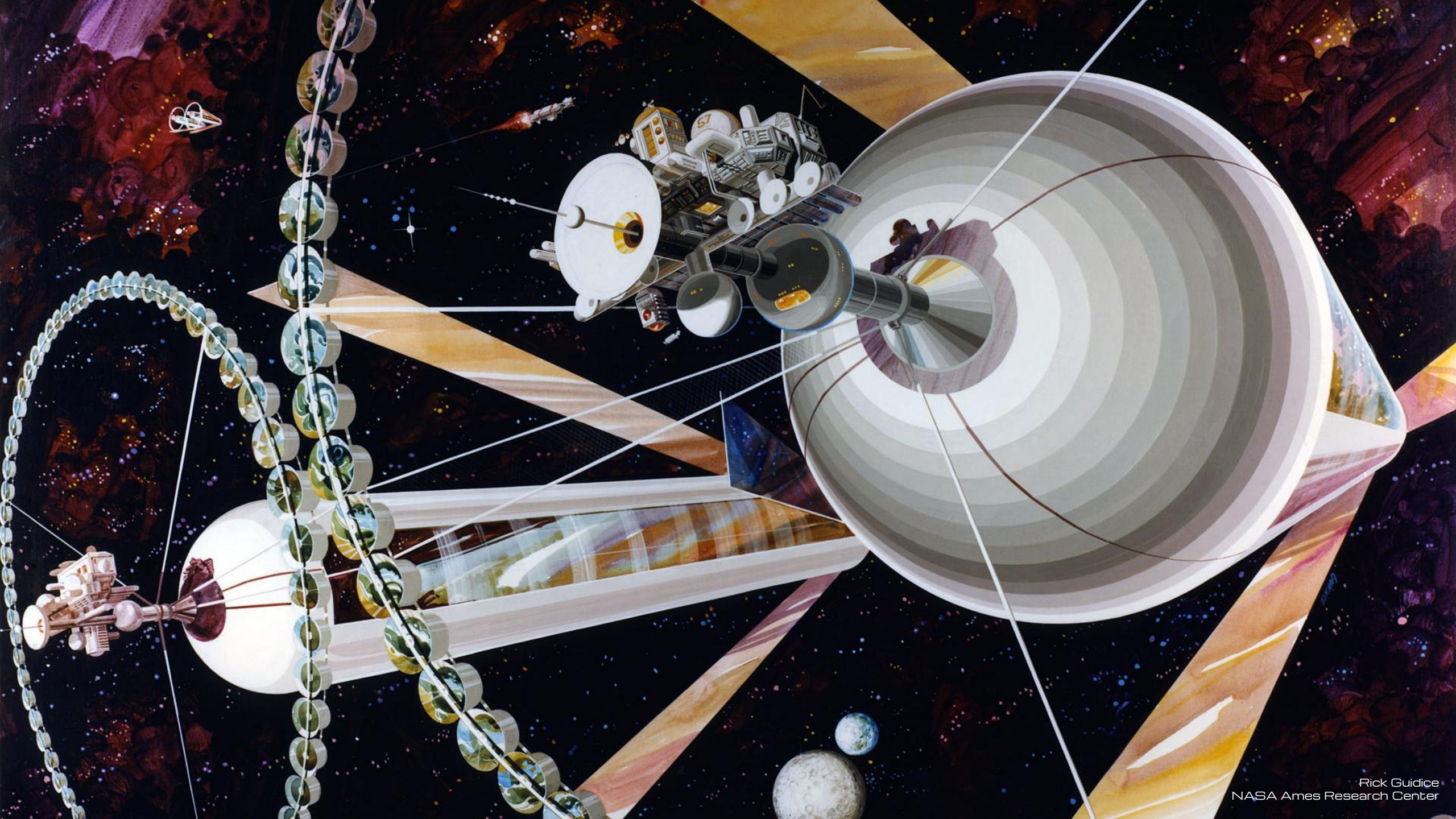
theguardian.com/world/ng-interactive/2025/sep/28/inside-the-everyday-facebook-networks-where-far-right-ideas-grow





INFRASTRUCTURE NETWORKS, INFORMATION NETWORKS

U.S. Department of Transportation
Federal Highway Administration
Office of Freight Management and Operations
Freight Analysis Framework
version 3.4, 2012





THE WAY THE FUTURE COULD BE

James & Kevlin

THE USBORNE BOOK OF
THE FUTURE
A VIEW FROM THE 1970s OF THE YEAR 2000... AND BEYOND



Unabridged,
unedited, and
un-updated!

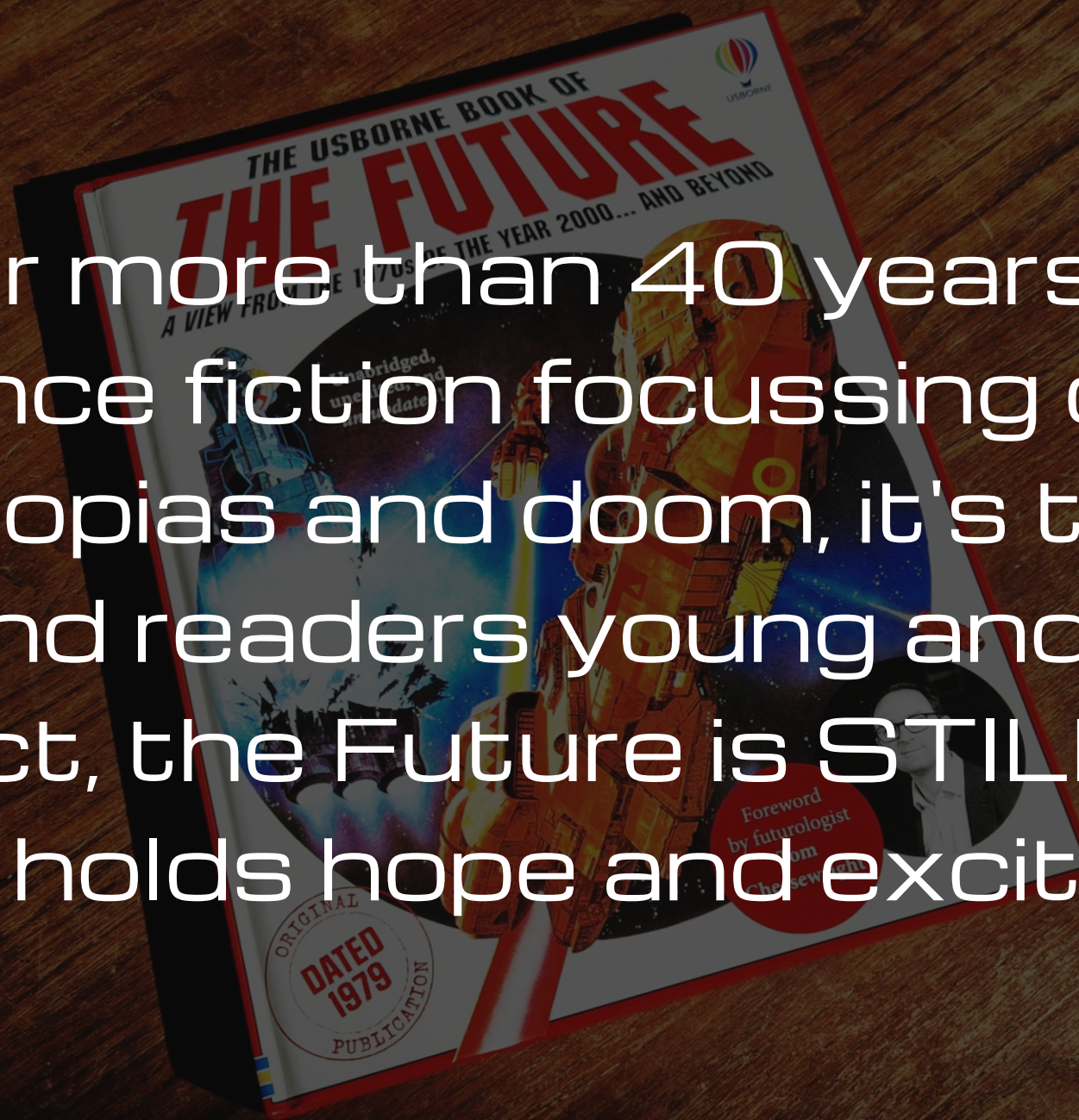


Foreword
by futurologist
Tom
Cheesewright



ORIGINAL
**DATED
1979**
PUBLICATION

After more than 40 years of science fiction focussing on dystopias and doom, it's time to remind readers young and old that, in fact, the Future is STILL a place that holds hope and excitement.





A landscape photograph featuring several wind turbines in a grassy field during sunset. The sky is a mix of orange, yellow, and dark blue, with the sun low on the horizon. In the foreground, several cows are grazing or resting in the field. The overall mood is serene yet contemplative, reflecting the theme of the text.

FROM CLOSED TO OPEN

Displacement
or addition?

China's tokamak sets new record

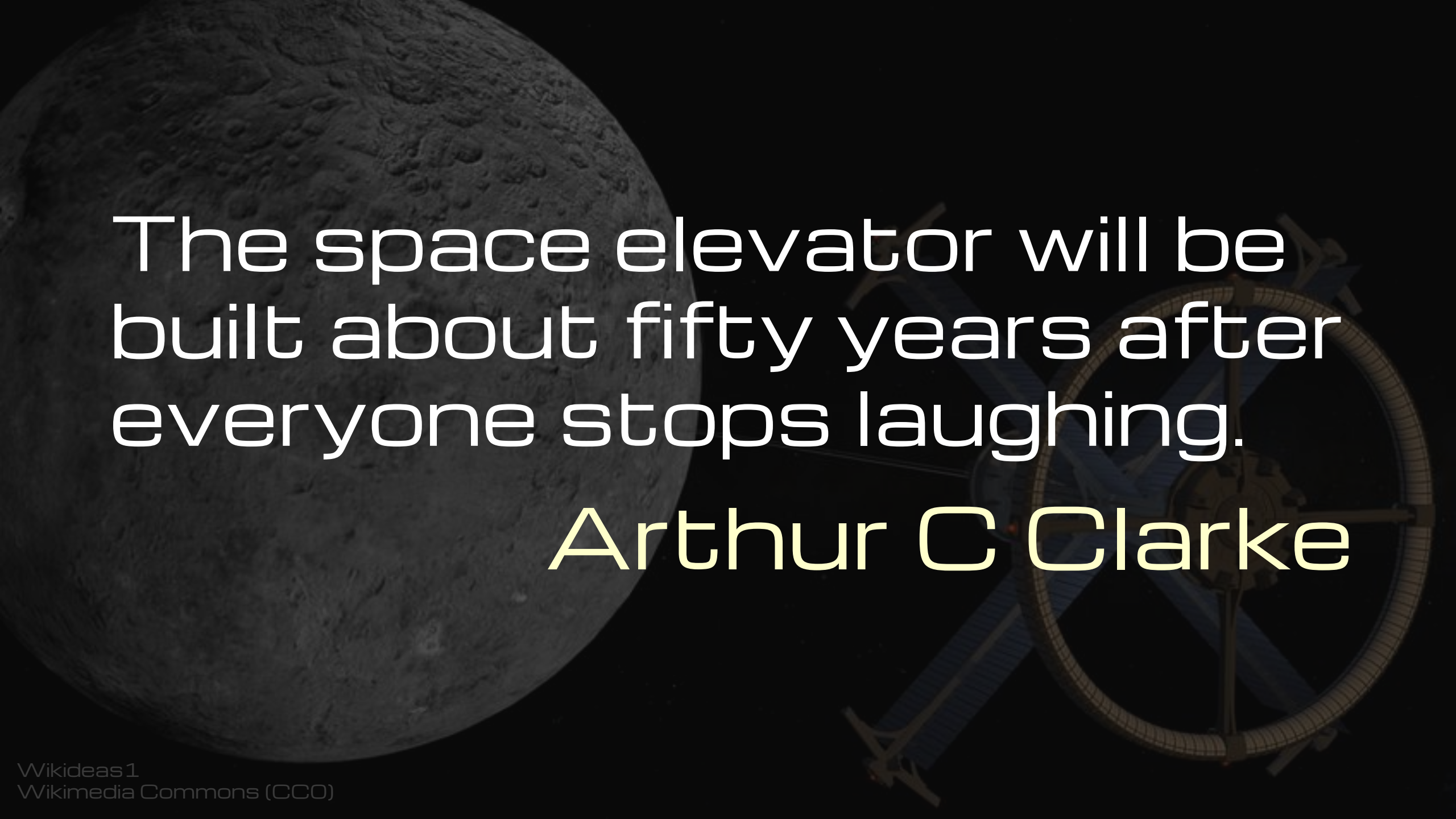
Staff Writer January 28, 2025



The Experimental Advanced Superconducting Tokamak based in Hefei, China, has sustained a high-pressure plasma for over 1000 seconds (Photo credit: Hefei Institute of Physical Science)

neimagazine.com/advanced-reactors-fusion/chinas-tokamak-sets-new-record





The space elevator will be
built about fifty years after
everyone stops laughing.

Arthur C Clarke



Venus

Mercury

Moon

Jupiter

Mars

Cerro Armazones

El Yunque

Welcome to the midpoint
of the second decade of
the 21st century, Human.

The solar system is
waking up.

Charles Stross
Accelerando

Moon

Jupiter

Mars

Cerro Armazones

Lilleilleg



A detailed 3D rendering of the USS Enterprise NCC-1701-D, shown from a high-angle perspective. The ship's saucer section is at the top, and the secondary hull with the nacelles is below it. The ship is dark grey with blue and red lights. The background is black.

**Change always comes later
than we think it should.**

Jean-Luc Picard

**Change is more gradual
than we think.**

Change is cumulative.



transmitting



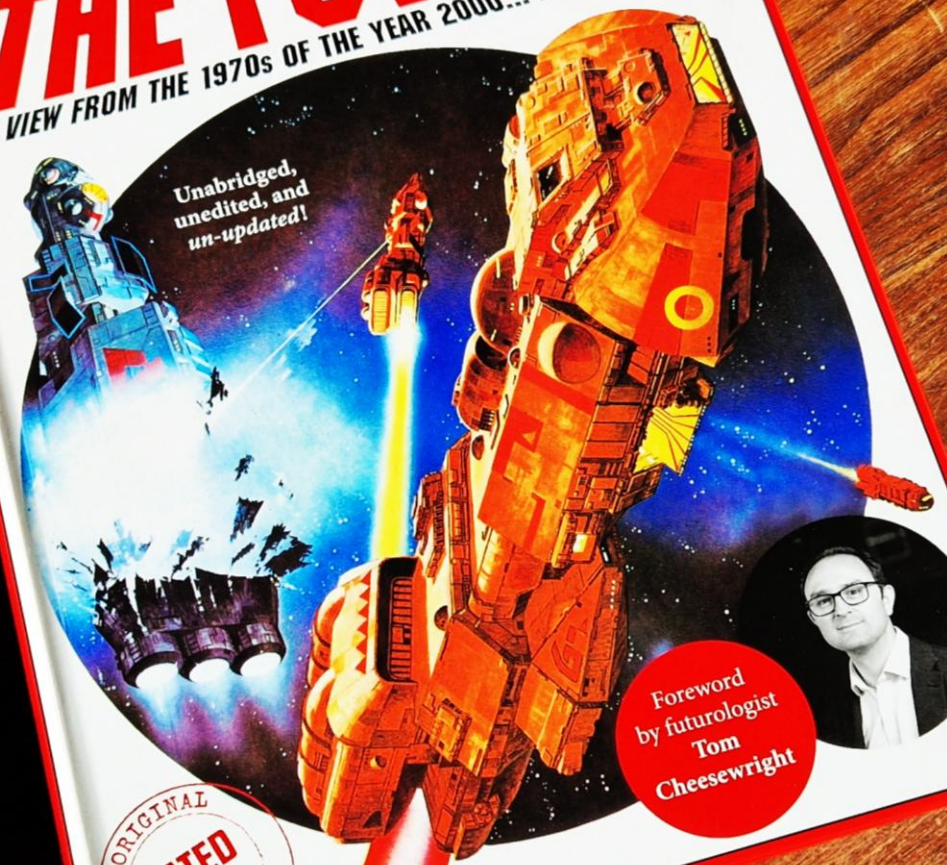
The background of the image is a dark, slightly blurred screenshot of a video call interface. In the center, a person's face is visible, looking directly at the camera. At the bottom of the screen, there is a red pill-shaped button with the word 'transmitting' in white, and to its right is a yellow square icon with a white '@' symbol. The text 'You don't get video phones by setting out to build video phones.' is overlaid in large, white, sans-serif font across the middle of the image.

You don't get video
phones by setting out
to build video phones.



THE USBORNE BOOK OF
THE FUTURE
A VIEW FROM THE 1970s OF THE YEAR 2000... AND BEYOND

Unabridged,
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Foreword
by futurologist
Tom
Cheesewright

ORIGINAL
**DATED
1979**
PUBLICATION

We still have choice.
We still have agency.
The future is still ours.





A dark, semi-transparent background image featuring the characters James and Kevlin from the movie The Goonies. James, on the left, has curly blonde hair and is wearing a patterned shirt. Kevlin, on the right, has long brown hair and is wearing a white t-shirt under a dark vest. Both are smiling and have their arms raised in a celebratory gesture. The background shows a dimly lit room with a red wall and a patterned floor.

BE EXCELLENT TO EACH OTHER

James & Kevlin